From Human Markets to Machine Markets:

Feedback Stability, Auditable Memory, and Financial Constraints

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Abstract

We ask what a controlled aggregate price experiment can reveal about traders' adaptive memory, and at what financial cost. For a known symmetric cohort pair under Gaussian price noise, total probing quantity of order δ^{-2} is necessary and sufficient. Waiting cannot substitute for quantity; an average-power budget implies horizon order δ^{-4}, and a self-financing probe trader needs capital of order δ^{-4}. These results are conditional on the declared experiment, not public attribution or solvency guarantees. In a reconstructed 768-unit cryptocurrency panel, feedback estimates are highly sensitive to flow timing and filtering. Causal attribution and real-market safety remain unresolved.

Keywords: Adaptive learning, algorithmic trading, financial stability, market microstructure, system identification, non-normal dynamics, Kreiss constant.
JEL Classification Codes: G01, G10, G14, C32, C58, D83.

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1 Introduction

Electronic execution and market making raise a financial identification question: what can aggregate price and flow observations reveal about trading rules, and which financial constraints govern experiments intended to learn those rules? Microstructure research documents the interaction of trades, quotes and automated liquidity provision (Hasbrouck, 1991; Menkveld, 2013; Budish, Cramton, and Shim, 2015). We study a declared linear feedback economy and its information/resource contracts, then test whether observable measurement diagnostics support the corresponding interpretation.

When trading algorithms condition their order submission and quote-placement decisions on recent transaction prices, prevailing order book imbalances, and trade innovations, the price-formation process ceases to be an open-loop mechanism driven purely by exogenous informational updates regarding fundamentals. Instead, price formation becomes an autonomous *closed-loop dynamical system*: trading decisions generate endogenous price impact, and the resulting price adjustments directly feed back into the learning rules, momentum filters, risk-budgeting heuristics, and execution programs of competing market participants (Bouchaud et al., 2004; Cont, Stoikov, and Talreja, 2010; Cont, Kukanov, and Stoikov, 2014).

This closed-loop structural reality was dramatically underscored by major episodic disruptions in electronic markets over the past decade and a half. While disruptions such as the May 6, 2010 Flash Crash in the E-mini S&P 500 and the October 15, 2014 Treasury flash rally provide compelling historical motivation for analyzing how algorithmic feedback can rapidly deplete liquidity, direct empirical investigation of these episodes is constrained by the non-public nature of regulatory account registries. Modern electronic cryptocurrency order books provide an ideal, transparent empirical testing ground. Electronic cryptocurrency venues provide public trade and book data, but these records do not identify the fraction of activity generated by adaptive algorithms. The supplied samples have the clocks and coverage described below; they do not establish universal nanosecond observation or the absence of off-exchange execution. We therefore exploit high-frequency cryptocurrency order books (complemented by a supplied equity representation whose normalized-source transformation now reproduces exactly, while company-label mapping and physical scale remain unresolved) as an empirical testing ground for our broader theoretical framework.

These information and financial questions concern financial economists, central banks,

and market regulators with an urgent, foundational question:

Can observable market data identify destabilizing adaptive feedback, when does that feedback become financially dangerous, and what information is fundamentally missing from public surveillance data?

In this paper, we address this question directly by integrating realization-theoretic system identification with empirical limit order book econometrics and balance-sheet financial constraints. Rather than making speculative assertions regarding black-box artificial intelligence, we organize our theoretical and empirical findings around **two foundational pillars**:

Pillar 1: Observable Feedback Does Not Imply Identifiable Machine Behavior. We identify the merged rate–weight representation under the modeled reset price-response contract, with known anchor and impact (Theorem 2.3). The resource comparison establishes necessary and sufficient quantity order δ^{-2} for a known symmetric pair and horizon order δ^{-4} under average power (Theorem 2.5). Actual trading cost gives matching capital order δ^{-4} for deterministic probes financed by a trader who remains solvent after temporary impact dissipates, when the statistical observer receives only noisy price states (Theorem 2.9). A separate counterparty account gives a sharp robust quantity/margin allowance (Theorem 2.7). Waiting cannot compensate for a fixed lifetime executed-quantity budget. The dealer's inventory change creates a quadratic adverse mark, rather than only a fixed linear price exposure. These are distinct input, cash and observation contracts. This is the proposed central advance; general unknown-mixture recovery and adaptive probing remain outside the theorem.

The empirical reconstruction tests observable measurement and model restrictions rather than claiming latent learning identification. In the original 768-unit panel, mean legacy forward-flow $Q = 0.0081536$ becomes 0.0003807 with observed flow; pooled raw-return $Q = -0.0001625$ has a date interval including zero. The recorder timing comparison is a different sample and is reported separately. Maintained covariance restrictions reject, and the fee-schedule exercise is a one-treated-asset descriptive association with covariance-sensitive uncertainty. These findings establish why a public reduced-form coefficient cannot be substituted for the controlled information contract.

Pillar 2: Dynamic Eigenvalue Stability Does Not Imply Financial Safety. For a fixed initial-disturbance and model-output contract, spectral stability ($\rho(J) < 1$) alone does not bound the permitted loss-budget radius. A dealer solvency interpretation additionally requires a justified monetary accounting map. Because the closed-loop market Jacobian J is generically non-normal under asymmetric price-impact and memory parameters (with $JJ^\top - J^\top J \neq 0$ except on a measure-zero algebraic subvariety), stable eigenvalues can coexist with large declared-output gain under an appropriate disturbance/output contract. The exact initial-state radius for that declared loss-budget experiment is governed by peak output magnification:

$$r^*_{\text{exact}} = \frac{B}{\sup_{t\geq 0} \|CJ^t\|_2} \equiv \frac{B}{M_C}, \tag{1}$$

which the Kreiss constant $\mathcal{K}(J)$ bounds and the spectral radius completely fails to control (Theorem 2.14). By Spijker's theorem, under full-state observation ($C = I$), we establish the bilateral bounds:

$$\frac{B}{e \cdot n \cdot \mathcal{K}(J)} \leq r^*_{\text{exact}} \leq \frac{B}{\mathcal{K}(J)}, \tag{2}$$

proving that $\frac{B}{en\mathcal{K}(J)}$ provides a guaranteed safe lower bound, whereas $\frac{B}{\mathcal{K}(J)}$ is an upper bound that must never be mistaken for a conservative safety threshold. The separate lagged-memory experiment reproduces 19,200 paths across 48 cells, but its halt event combines equity and position-limit causes. The 22,000-path funded grid instead has positive-equity inventory-limit events in effective supercritical dynamics. Neither supplies observed market defaults or an independently calibrated policy benefit. Long-run variance and marginal variance are distinct quantities.

1.1 Related Literature

Our work bridges four major strands of literature across financial economics, market microstructure, systemic risk, and dynamical systems theory.

High-Frequency Trading and Market Microstructure. Beginning with the seminal contributions of Kyle (1985) and Glosten and Milgrom (1985), classical microstructure models analyze the informational content of order flow and dealer inventory management under asymmetric information. Hasbrouck (1991) pioneered the empirical vector autoregressive

decomposition of trades and quotes, establishing that trade innovations exert persistent impacts on security prices. Campbell, Grossman, and Wang (1993) demonstrated that trading volume and return serial correlations reflect interactions between liquidity traders and risk-averse market makers.

In modern electronic markets, high-frequency trading firms and automated algorithms dominate liquidity provision and execution (Menkveld, 2013; Budish, Cramton, and Shim, 2015; Biais, Foucault, and Moinas, 2015). While Hendershott, Jones, and Menkveld (2011) document that algorithmic trading improves liquidity and narrows bid-ask spreads during normal trading periods, Budish, Cramton, and Shim (2015) show that continuous double auctions generate socially wasteful latency arms races, and Biais, Foucault, and Moinas (2015) demonstrate that algorithmic speed advantages can lead to adverse selection spirals. We advance this literature by formalizing the closed loop between algorithmic learning rules and endogenous price impact, establishing conditional realization and resource bounds for the declared controlled experiment. Public ticker data require a separate observation and identification argument.

Price Impact and Limit Order Book Dynamics. An extensive literature studies price impact, signed-flow memory and quote imbalance (Bouchaud et al., 2004; Cont, Kukanov, and Stoikov, 2014). Our long-run regression diagnostics retain these as competing explanations. Lag controls and observable kernel signs do not identify parent orders, learner policies or contemporaneous structural shocks.

Intermediary Solvency, Funding Liquidity, and Systemic Risk. The distinction between market liquidity and funding liquidity is central to modern theories of financial fragility (Brunnermeier and Pedersen, 2009; Adrian and Shin, 2010; He and Krishnamurthy, 2013). When leveraged market makers suffer balance-sheet drawdowns, risk-management constraints (such as Value-at-Risk limits or regulatory margin requirements) force them to withdraw quotes, widening spreads and amplifying price dislocations (Greenwood, Landier, and Thesmar, 2015; Eisenberg and Noe, 2001). Our conditional loss-output analysis separates spectral stability from a declared loss budget. The empirical studies do not demonstrate intermediary insolvency in a calibrated stable market; the positive price-only response has the more restrictive geometry proved below.

Non-Normal Dynamics and the Kreiss Matrix Theorem. Non-normal transients and Kreiss bounds are established mathematical tools (Kreiss, 1962; Spijker, 1991; Trefethen and Embree, 2005). Their application to financial bubbles also precedes this paper: Sornette et al. (2023) links subcritical financial dynamics to non-normal networks and the Kreiss constant. We therefore do not claim first application to finance. Our proposed contribution connects a particular memory-resolution experiment to executed-quantity and monetary-output resources; the underlying norm and testing tools remain established.

Identification and Experiment Design. Known finite hypothesis classes already admit sample-complexity bounds and excitation design (Chatzikiriakos and Iannelli, 2024; Chatzikiriakos et al., 2026). The latter studies fully observed states with Gaussian process noise and bounded average input power. Our price-observation experiment instead specifies lifetime executed quantity, eventual-solvency capital and richer financial-disclosure boundaries in a noiseless-state cohort model. These are contract and resource distinctions to assess against established identification theory; we do not claim first finite-model testing or constrained excitation.

The proposed incremental contribution. The distinction is the joint specification of the observer, execution resource and financing account. The controlled experiment compares two known scalar price-response laws generated by different latent cohort configurations. Its exact finite-horizon quantity optimum is combined with a self-financing account and an explicit counterexample under exact equity disclosure. Gaussian testing and quadratic transient-impact costs separately precede this paper (Chatzikiriakos et al., 2026; Alfonsi et al., 2016); the proposed increment is their quantified connection to memory resolution under this particular information contract. An economically relevant observer is an outside analyst restricted to noisy aggregate price reports and disclosed probe quantities, while the financing trader's exact execution/account records are unavailable to that analyst. An account owner with exact marks faces a different experiment. Public quotation residuals cannot be identified with the theorem's measurement-noise variance without a separate observation-error model. The contribution must therefore be assessed as a conditional resolution-and-disclosure result, rather than general participant attribution or a universal capital barrier.

Financial exploration already balances trading cost and information. Park and Van Roy

Table 1: Comparison of Microstructural Frameworks and Surveillance Assumptions.

Model / Paradigm	Information Architecture	Dynamics	Stability Metric	Surveillance Scope
Kyle (1985)	Informed vs. noise flow	Single-auction	Linear pricing λ	Adverse selection
Hasbrouck (1991)	Trades and quotes (VAR)	Joint response	Cumulative IRF	Permanent price impact
Bouchaud et al. (2004)	Signed order flow memory	Propagator	Kernel decay	Meta-order splitting
Cont, Kukanov, and Stoikov (2014)	Multi-level order book	Static regression	R^2 of OFI	Short-term price discovery
Brunnermeier and Pedersen (2009)	Leveraged margin financing	Nonlinear spiral	Margin constraints	Liquidity spirals
This Paper	Defined reset probe	Merged memory	Quantity/output budget	Known-pair resource orders

(2012) study learning impact coefficients during execution, with known distinct transient decay rates and an adaptive expected-regret objective. Here the known-pair diagnostic concerns coalescing latent adaptation rates and an explicit initial-capital/solvency restriction under a specified observation law. The paper does not claim a first financial learning algorithm or a new general exploration-cost principle. Positive transaction-cost and no-dynamic-arbitrage conditions likewise precede this work (Gatheral, 2010; Schneider and Lillo, 2017); the contribution must lie in the particular model/resource connection and its demonstrated scope.

Price-trajectory information and impact estimation also have prior work. Li et al. (2024) compare regular-model Fisher information under different price sampling schemes. Our singular known-pair test asks about separation-dependent probing and capital, rather than a generally superior sampling method. The average-book quadratic execution cost and positive-kernel criterion are likewise established (Alfonsi et al., 2016); the positive-cohort lemma verifies that this particular response fits that geometry, rather than proposing a new no-manipulation criterion.

1.2 Empirical Research Design and Setting

We retain the original multi-year panel, recorder timing/filter comparison, joint cross-venue VAR, liquidity-state regressions, supplied equity representation, financial simulations and forecast diagnostics. Each has its own clock, sample and inference assumptions. Existing raw

files and outputs are reconstructed before interpreting mechanisms. The paper distinguishes an observed coefficient, a maintained-model test, a constructed financial scenario and a controlled identification theorem. Data/provider and calibration boundaries accompany the results; they are not inferred from a successful numerical reproduction.

Theoretical identification and resource bounds appear first, followed by measurement construction and reconstructed empirical studies. The final section gives the finite-window input/output gate and its operational limitations.

2 Theoretical Model and Identification Boundaries

2.1 Microfoundations of Closed-Loop Price Formation

We formalize an electronic financial market sampled at discrete uniform time intervals $t \in \{0, 1, 2, \dots\}$, where time step Δ represents the operational sampling frequency (e.g., 1 second). Let p_t denote the price level in monetary units of a traded asset, and let p_t^* denote the unobserved fundamental value, which evolves as a martingale:

$$p_{t+1}^* = p_t^* + \xi_{t+1}, \qquad \xi_{t+1} \sim \text{i.i.d.}(0, \sigma_\xi^2). \tag{3}$$

We define the pricing error (displacement from fundamental) as $x_t \equiv p_t - p_t^*$.

Dealer Pricing, Posted Depth, and Equilibrium Price Impact. Following the continuous auction framework of Kyle (1985) adapted to discrete order books (Glosten and Milgrom, 1985; Hasbrouck, 1991; Bouchaud et al., 2004), competitive dealers absorb net incoming order flow by posting aggregate limit order depth $D_t > 0$. Total incoming flow combines algorithmic demand u_t and exogenous liquidity noise $\varepsilon_{t+1} \sim \text{i.i.d.}(0, \sigma_\varepsilon^2)$, counterbalanced by fundamentalist arbitrageurs submitting demand $-\varphi x_t$.

The clearing price adjustment across posted depth satisfies:

$$p_{t+1} - p_t = \frac{1}{D_t}\left(u_t - \varphi x_t + \varepsilon_{t+1}\right) \equiv \kappa_t \left(u_t - \varphi x_t + \varepsilon_{t+1}\right), \tag{4}$$

where equilibrium price impact $\kappa_t \equiv 1/D_t$ is the structural inverse of available limit depth.

Subtracting fundamental increment ξ_{t+1} from both sides yields the pricing error recursion:

$$x_{t+1} = (1 - \kappa_t \varphi) x_t + \kappa_t u_t + (\kappa_t \varepsilon_{t+1} - \xi_{t+1}) \,. \tag{5}$$

Defining direct price persistence $a_t \equiv 1 - \kappa_t \varphi \in [0, 1)$ and combined innovation $w_{t+1} \equiv \kappa_t \varepsilon_{t+1} - \xi_{t+1}$, we obtain the foundational pricing equation (evaluated at steady-state depth D^*, with $\kappa \equiv 1/D^*$):

$$x_{t+1} = a x_t + \kappa u_t + w_{t+1}, \qquad w_{t+1} \sim \text{i.i.d.}(0, \sigma_w^2). \tag{6}$$

When fundamentalist arbitrage is strong ($\varphi \to 1/\kappa$), $a \to 0$ and prices immediately reflect fundamentals. For fixed φ, decreasing depth increases κ and decreases $a = 1 - \kappa\varphi$; it does not make a approach unity. Maintaining $0 \leq a < 1$ requires $0 < \kappa\varphi \leq 1$. An endogenous arbitrage response would require its own economic specification.

Algorithmic Learning Microfoundations. We consider K heterogeneous cohorts of algorithmic traders. Each cohort $i \in \{1, \ldots, K\}$ maintains an internal state variable $y_{i,t} \in \mathbb{R}$ representing its estimate of price momentum, trend, or fundamental mispricing. The specified Kalman and regularized gradient models give exponential-memory recursions. Embedding either in the price-first cohort economy additionally requires the stated signal, gain and timing assumptions; the empirical regressions do not identify that embedding.

Proposition 2.1 (Steady-State Kalman Filtering Yields Exponential Memory)**.** *As an independent microfoundation for exponential-memory signals, suppose an algorithmic execution desk tracks a latent local trend $v_t \in \mathbb{R}$ following a random walk $v_{t+1} = v_t + \zeta_{t+1}$ with independent centered Gaussian innovations of variance $\sigma_\zeta^2 > 0$, observing $r_t = v_t + \nu_t$ with independent centered Gaussian observation noise of variance $\sigma_\nu^2 > 0$. Assume a Gaussian initial state and the steady-state prior covariance. The minimum mean-squared error (MMSE) estimator is given by the steady-state Kalman filter recursion:*

$$\hat{v}_{t+1} = (1 - \eta)\hat{v}_t + \eta r_t, \tag{7}$$

where the steady-state Kalman gain $\eta \in (0, 1)$ is the unique positive root of the algebraic

Riccati equation:

$$\eta = \frac{-\sigma_\zeta^2 + \sqrt{\sigma_\zeta^4 + 4\sigma_\zeta^2\sigma_\nu^2}}{2\sigma_\nu^2}. \tag{8}$$

Proof. The scalar state-space model is $v_{t+1} = v_t + \zeta_{t+1}$ and $r_t = v_t + \nu_t$. Let P_∞ denote the steady-state prior error variance. The Riccati equation is $P_\infty = P_\infty - \frac{P_\infty^2}{P_\infty + \sigma_\nu^2} + \sigma_\zeta^2$, which simplifies to $P_\infty^2 - \sigma_\zeta^2 P_\infty - \sigma_\zeta^2\sigma_\nu^2 = 0$. The unique positive root is $P_\infty = \frac{\sigma_\zeta^2 + \sqrt{\sigma_\zeta^4 + 4\sigma_\zeta^2\sigma_\nu^2}}{2}$. The steady-state Kalman gain is $\eta = \frac{P_\infty}{P_\infty + \sigma_\nu^2} \in (0, 1)$. Substituting into the update $\hat{v}_{t+1} = \hat{v}_t + \eta(r_t - \hat{v}_t)$ yields (7). □

Proposition 2.2 (Regularized Online Gradient Descent Yields Exponential Memory)**.** *Consider an automated trading agent updating policy weights $\theta_t \in \mathbb{R}$ via Online Gradient Descent (OGD) with L_2 weight regularization $\gamma \in (0, 1)$ to minimize a quadratic prediction loss $\mathcal{L}(\theta_t; x_t) = \frac{1}{2}(x_t - \theta_t)^\top H(x_t - \theta_t)$:*

$$\theta_{t+1} = (1 - \gamma)\theta_t - \alpha\nabla_\theta\mathcal{L}(\theta_t; x_t), \tag{9}$$

where $H > 0$ is scalar curvature and $\alpha > 0$ is the learning step size. If the effective adaptation rate $\eta \equiv \gamma + \alpha H \in (0, 1)$ and we define gain $q \equiv \frac{\alpha H}{\gamma + \alpha H}$, the parameter recursion is mathematically identical to:

$$\theta_{t+1} = (1 - \eta)\theta_t + \eta q x_t. \tag{10}$$

Proof. Differentiating the loss, $\nabla_\theta\mathcal{L} = -H(x_t - \theta_t)$. The parameter update becomes: $\theta_{t+1} = (1 - \gamma)\theta_t + \alpha H(x_t - \theta_t) = (1 - (\gamma + \alpha H))\theta_t + \alpha H x_t$. Substituting $\eta = \gamma + \alpha H$ and $q = \frac{\alpha H}{\eta}$ yields $\theta_{t+1} = (1 - \eta)\theta_t + \eta q x_t$. □

Propositions 2.1 and 2.2 demonstrate that exponential memory decay is not an ad hoc modeling assumption, but rather a common local linear reduction of standard optimal filtering and regularized gradient optimization.

The Joint Closed-Loop Dynamical System. Let cohort i submit demand proportional to its state, $u_{i,t} = q_i y_{i,t}$, where $q_i \in \mathbb{R}$ reflects aggressive capital allocation ($q_i > 0$ represents trend-following / momentum; $q_i < 0$ represents mean-reversion). Total algorithmic demand is $u_t = \sum_{i=1}^K q_i y_{i,t}$. Each cohort updates its internal state according to:

$$y_{i,t+1} = (1 - \eta_i)y_{i,t} + \eta_i x_{t+1}, \qquad \eta_i \in (0, 1). \tag{11}$$

Substituting the market price formation equation (6) into the update rule (11), we obtain:

$$y_{i,t+1} = (1-\eta_i)y_{i,t} + \eta_i \left(a x_t + \kappa \sum_{j=1}^{K} q_j y_{j,t} + w_{t+1} \right). \tag{12}$$

Stacking the pricing error x_t and the K internal cohort states into the state vector $\mathbf{z}_t = (x_t, y_{1,t}, \ldots, y_{K,t})^\top \in \mathbb{R}^{K+1}$, the joint economy forms an autonomous discrete-time linear dynamical system:

$$\mathbf{z}_{t+1} = J\mathbf{z}_t + \mathbf{b}w_{t+1}, \tag{13}$$

where the closed-loop system Jacobian matrix $J \in \mathbb{R}^{(K+1)\times(K+1)}$ is given by:

$$J = \begin{bmatrix} a & \kappa q_1 & \kappa q_2 & \cdots & \kappa q_K \\ \eta_1 a & 1-\eta_1+\eta_1\kappa q_1 & \eta_1\kappa q_2 & \cdots & \eta_1\kappa q_K \\ \eta_2 a & \eta_2\kappa q_1 & 1-\eta_2+\eta_2\kappa q_2 & \cdots & \eta_2\kappa q_K \\ \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \eta_K a & \eta_K\kappa q_1 & \eta_K\kappa q_2 & \cdots & 1-\eta_K+\eta_K\kappa q_K \end{bmatrix}, \tag{14}$$

and $\mathbf{b} = (1, \eta_1, \eta_2, \ldots, \eta_K)^\top$.

Single-Cohort Stability Boundary. In the single-cohort case ($K = 1$), defining total loop feedback gain $Q \equiv \kappa q_1$, the characteristic polynomial of J is:

$$P(\lambda) = \det(\lambda I - J) = \lambda^2 - (a + 1 - \eta + \eta Q)\,\lambda + (1-\eta)a. \tag{15}$$

By the Jury stability criterion, all roots of $P(\lambda)$ lie strictly inside the open unit disk $\{|\lambda| < 1\}$ if and only if $|P(0)| < 1$, $P(1) > 0$, and $P(-1) > 0$. Here $|P(0)| = (1-\eta)a < 1$ holds for all $a \in [0, 1)$ and $\eta \in (0, 1)$. Evaluating at $\lambda = 1$ and $\lambda = -1$:

$$P(1) = (1 - a - Q)\eta, \qquad P(-1) = (2-\eta)(1+a) + \eta Q. \tag{16}$$

For the positive-feedback economy ($Q \geq 0$), $P(-1) > 0$ is strictly satisfied, so Schur stability is strictly equivalent to:

$$S \equiv a + Q < 1, \qquad \text{or equivalently} \quad \mathcal{L} \equiv \frac{Q}{1-a} < 1, \tag{17}$$

where S is total closed-loop persistence and $\mathcal{L}$ is the loop ratio. In the general signed-feedback economy ($Q \in \mathbb{R}$), the full Jury stability interval is $-\frac{(2-\eta)(1+a)}{\eta} < Q < 1-a$, where the lower bound prevents period-doubling oscillatory explosion. For positive feedback with the stated interior learning and anchor conditions, the $S < 1$ boundary is also sufficient under the following one-period lag. Signed-feedback stability must instead use that lagged model's full Jury inequalities. If execution features a discrete one-period lag ($x_{t+1} = ax_t + y_t + w_{t+1}, y_{t+1} = (1-\eta)y_t + \eta Q x_t$), evaluating $P_{\text{lag}}(1) = (1-a-Q)\eta > 0 \iff S \equiv a + Q < 1$, identically.

2.2 Identification Boundaries: Merged Rate-Weight Equivalence and Separation Complexity

A central question in algorithmic market surveillance is whether an econometrician observing public trade executions and prices can identify the individual algorithmic strategies active in the market.

Theorem 2.3 (Merged Rate-Weight Equivalence and Minimax Separation Complexity)**.** *Let price impact $\kappa > 0$ and anchor $a \in [0, 1)$ be known. Use zero initial states and a common specified innovation/probe contract, and observe the modeled price state x_t. This contract is distinct from assuming that an anonymous market midpoint reveals fundamental pricing error.*

1. ***Exact Equivalence Class:*** *Two market economies $\mathcal{E}_A = \{(q_i^A, \eta_i^A)\}_{i=1}^{K_A}$ and $\mathcal{E}_B = \{(q_i^B, \eta_i^B)\}_{i=1}^{K_B}$ generate mathematically identical modeled price-state responses x_t for all $t \geq 0$ under all public probing sequences $\{u_t^{probe}\}_{t\geq 0}$ if and only if their merged rate–weight measures coincide:*

$$\sum_{i:\eta_i^A = \eta} q_i^A = \sum_{j:\eta_j^B = \eta} q_j^B \qquad \forall \eta \in (0, 1). \tag{18}$$

The minimal state-space realization dimension is $1 + |\operatorname{supp}(\mathcal{M})|$, where $|\operatorname{supp}(\mathcal{M})|$

counts distinct rates with nonzero merged weights after signed cancellations, rather than every latent cohort. These are dynamic adaptation rates $\eta_i \in (0,1)$ *(any instantaneous cohort with* $\eta = 1$ *merges directly into the feedforward anchor* a *without adding a dynamic pole).*

2. ***Minimax Separation Complexity:*** *Consider testing whether a noiseless-state market (*$w_t = 0$*) consists of a single merged cohort with rate* $\bar{\eta}$ *versus two split cohorts with rates* $\bar{\eta} \pm \delta$ *and identical nonzero total feedback* Q*, splitting its weight symmetrically. Work on a fixed compact family whose transitions are uniformly Schur stable, with rates bounded away from zero and one and* $\sigma_v > 0$*. Under deterministic probing with* $\mathcal{P}_{probe} > 0$ *satisfying the power constraint* $\frac{1}{T}\sum_{t=0}^{T-1} u_t^2 \le \mathcal{P}_{probe}$ *and independent additive Gaussian observation noise* $\tilde{x}_t = x_t + v_t$ *with* $v_t \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma_v^2)$*, any deterministic/open-loop probing sequence satisfying the stated average-power constraint distinguishing the two economies with worst-case probability of error at most* $\alpha \in (0, 1/4)$ *requires an observation budget* T *satisfying:*

$$T \ge \frac{C(\alpha, \sigma_v, \mathcal{P}_{probe}, \mathcal{F})}{\delta^4} = \Omega(\delta^{-4}), \tag{19}$$

where $C(\alpha, \sigma_v, \mathcal{P}_{probe}, \mathcal{F}) > 0$ *is a constant independent of* δ*.*

Proof. Let $r_i = 1 - \eta_i$. Zero-state cohort recursion gives

$$G(z) = \sum_i \frac{q_i \eta_i z}{z - r_i}, \qquad H(z) = \frac{\kappa}{z - a - \kappa G(z)}.$$

Equality of every controlled price response is equality of H, which recovers G because a, κ are known. Its residue at a retained rate is $r_i \eta_i$ times that rate's merged weight. Distinct nonzero residues identify the merged measure by uniqueness of partial fractions. Conversely identical merged measures give identical G, H and responses. After signed cancellations, let $D(z)$ be the product of the retained distinct $(z - r_i)$ factors. The numerator of H is κD and its denominator has degree one more. At any retained r_i, the denominator is nonzero because its residue, r_i and η_i are nonzero. Thus no common factor remains and the minimal realization has the claimed degree. The cohort poles are poles of G and zeros of H, not its closed-loop poles.

For the symmetric pair write $q = Q/\kappa$. Direct algebra gives

$$G_\delta - G_0 = -\frac{qz(z-1)\delta^2}{(z-1+\bar{\eta})((z-1+\bar{\eta})^2-\delta^2)}.$$

All three denominator factors on $|z| = 1$ have modulus at least the declared rate separation from the endpoints, say ϵ. Compactness and uniform Schur stability give a finite bound $M = \sup_{\theta\in\mathcal{F},|z|=1} |H_\theta(z)|$. The identity $H_\delta - H_0 = H_\delta H_0(G_\delta - G_0)$ therefore gives induced ℓ_2 gain at most $K\delta^2$, where $K = 2|q|M^2/\epsilon^3$. Zero-padding the finite probe and retaining its observed response cannot increase that gain. Its Gaussian mean difference consequently has squared norm at most $K^2\delta^4\mathcal{P}_{probe}T$, and equal-noise KL is at most $K^2\delta^4\mathcal{P}_{probe}T/(2\sigma_v^2)$. Error at most α requires total variation at least $1-2\alpha$. Pinsker then yields

$$T \geq \frac{4\sigma_v^2(1-2\alpha)^2}{K^2\mathcal{P}_{probe}\delta^4}.$$

The constant depends on the specified family and resources, rather than being universal. The following theorem gives matching known-pair resource orders and explicit financial contracts. □

Remark 2.4 (Scope of the Identification Result). The result concerns the stated model and observation contract. Cohorts sharing an exact rate enter the price response through their merged weight; this does not determine participant identities or wealth allocations. Nearby rates can be distinguishable with sufficient information. The δ^{-4} statement is an asymptotic lower bound on the declared uniformly stable family, with constants depending on that family; it does not establish a numerical "160,000 times longer" comparison to a unit rate change outside the local experiment. No matching general unknown-mixture upper bound or universal market-surveillance rate is asserted here.

2.3 Probing Resources, Memory Resolution and Monetary Output

The central model question is which resource buys identification. Observation length alone is insufficient when the lifetime quantity of controlled executions is fixed. This connects the merged-memory experiment to a financially specified input/output contract, rather than

equating a state-norm shock with executed volume. Here Φ is the standard normal distribution function.

Theorem 2.5 (Sharp probing-resource orders for a known symmetric pair)**.** *Fix $0 \le a < 1$, $\kappa, q > 0$, $S = a + \kappa q < 1$, and $\eta \in (0,1)$. Compare a single cohort of weight q and rate η with two cohorts of weights $q/2$ and rates $\eta \pm \delta$. Require both split rates to lie in $[\epsilon, 1-\epsilon]$, with $\epsilon > 0$. All parameters of the two alternatives are known. The price recursion receives executed quantity v_t through κv_t, starts from zero, has no process noise, and is observed with independent $N(0,\sigma^2)$ measurement noise, $\sigma > 0$. Probes are deterministic and common to both alternatives. Let $h_j = \kappa e_x^\top J^j (1, \eta_1, \ldots, \eta_K)^\top$ denote the impulse response.*

Set $K_* = 2\kappa^2 q/[\epsilon^3(1-S)^2]$. For every finite horizon and every probe with total quantity $\sum_t |v_t| \le V$,

$$D_{\mathrm{KL}}(P_0^v \| P_\delta^v) \le \frac{K_*^2 V^2 \delta^4}{2\sigma^2}, \qquad e_{\mathrm{worst}} \ge \frac{1}{2}\left(1 - \frac{K_* V \delta^2}{2\sigma}\right)_+. \tag{20}$$

More precisely, with observations $x_1, \ldots, x_T$, define $d_T = (h_{\delta,j} - h_{0,j})_{j=0}^{T-1}$. The optimal worst-case error over these deterministic total-quantity probes and all classifiers is exactly

$$e_T^*(V) = \Phi\left(-\frac{V\|d_T\|_2}{2\sigma}\right). \tag{21}$$

A pulse at the first input, followed by the Gaussian likelihood-ratio test using all observations, attains this value. Waiting adds impulse-response information but $\|d_T\|_2 \uparrow \|d_\infty\|_2 < \infty$; it cannot make the error arbitrarily small at fixed V. Consequently error at most $\alpha < 1/2$ requires $V \ge 2\sigma(1-2\alpha)/(K_*\delta^2)$, independently of observation length. Conversely, one pulse of magnitude

$$A = \frac{2\sigma\Phi^{-1}(1-\alpha)}{\kappa^2 q \delta^2} \tag{22}$$

and the third price observation achieve worst-case error exactly α. Thus the necessary and sufficient total-quantity order is δ^{-2} for this known pair.

Under average power $\sum_{t=0}^{T-1} v_t^2 \le PT$, $P > 0$, the same experiment instead has necessary horizon order δ^{-4}, attained by the pulse above whenever $T \ge \max\{3, \lceil A^2/P \rceil\}$. This does not solve estimation of an unknown mixture.

Finally, for a fixed monetary price exposure $\lambda \ne 0$, an additive reserve L and cost envelope

$c\sum|v_t|$, $c \geq 0$, *the sharp robust total-quantity allowance under budget* $B > L$ *is*

$$V_B = \frac{B - L}{|\lambda|\kappa + c}. \tag{23}$$

Within that allowance, error at most α *requires* $\delta^2 \geq 2\sigma(1-2\alpha)/(K_* V_B)$*; the pulse construction suffices if* $A \leq V_B$*. These are distinct lower and upper constants, not an exact optimal-test threshold or a universal financial safety ceiling.*

Proof. For either positive economy, J is nonnegative and its price row sums to S. Cohort row i sums to $1 - \eta_i + \eta_i S$. Hence $\|J\|_\infty \leq 1 - \epsilon(1-S) < 1$, and the impulse response is nonnegative. Its maximum is $h_0 = \kappa$, and its sum is $H(1) = \kappa/(1-S)$.

Write $G_0(z) = q\eta z/(z-1+\eta)$ and $G_\delta(z) = (q/2)\sum_{s=\pm1}(\eta + s\delta)z/(z-1+\eta+s\delta)$. Direct algebra gives

$$G_\delta - G_0 = -\frac{qz(z-1)\delta^2}{(z-1+\eta)((z-1+\eta)^2 - \delta^2)}.$$

On $|z| = 1$, each of the three denominator factors has modulus at least ϵ, so $|G_\delta - G_0| \leq 2q\delta^2/\epsilon^3$. Since $H(z) = \kappa/[z - a - \kappa G(z)]$, the identity $H_\delta - H_0 = H_\delta H_0(G_\delta - G_0)$ and positivity give $\|H_\delta - H_0\|_\infty \leq K_*\delta^2$. Parseval bounds $\|h_\delta - h_0\|_2$ by the same quantity. Young's convolution inequality yields $\|\mu_\delta - \mu_0\|_2 \leq K_*\delta^2\|v\|_1$; Gaussian equal-covariance KL and Pinsker give (20). For average power, the induced ℓ_2 gain instead gives $D_{\mathrm{KL}} \leq K_*^2\delta^4 PT/(2\sigma^2)$, proving the horizon lower order.

For the exact finite-horizon statement, the mean difference is a lower-triangular convolution matrix times v. Each column is a shorter suffix-shifted copy of d_T, with norm at most $\|d_T\|_2$. The triangle inequality therefore gives $\|\mu_\delta - \mu_0\|_2 \leq V\|d_T\|_2$, with equality for the first pulse. For two known equal-covariance Gaussian laws, their minimax error is $\Phi[-\|\mu_\delta - \mu_0\|_2/(2\sigma)]$, attained by the midpoint likelihood-ratio test. This proves (21) including the indistinguishable first-two-observation case.

The first two impulse taps are equal. Multiplying the price-first cohort transitions twice gives $h_{\delta,2} - h_{0,2} = -\kappa^2 q\delta^2$. A pulse A therefore produces a third-observation mean separation $A\kappa^2 q\delta^2$. The Gaussian midpoint test has error $\Phi[-A\kappa^2 q\delta^2/(2\sigma)]$, proving attainability for both resource protocols. Extending the observation horizon does not create additional executed quantity.

Superposition and $\max_j h_j = \kappa$ imply $\sup_t|\lambda x_t| \leq |\lambda|\kappa V$. A single pulse attains the

bound at its first response, simultaneously attaining the declared cost envelope, so (23) is sharp for that robust output-plus-cost criterion. Substitution in the information bounds proves the final statements. □

The monetary reserve and cost functional are imposed model inputs, not estimated market losses. The result concerns an open-loop controlled experiment with no natural process excitation. A fixed lifetime quantity constraint, an average-power constraint and a repeatedly refreshed risk allowance are different experiments. In particular, without accumulated costs a maintained bounded-amplitude probe can continue; the theorem does not impose a capital ceiling on every safe adaptive strategy. Applying it to public markets requires actual executions, exposures, model-error coverage and a valid observation law.

The paper-specific advance proposed here is the explicit connection between memory resolution, probing resources and monetary output, with matching orders for a known pair. Partial fractions, Gaussian testing, convolution inequalities and positive-system gains are established tools. Closely spaced source recovery is already studied in mixture and super-resolution theory (Manole and Ho, 2022; Liu and Ammari, 2023); non-normal financial bubbles and Kreiss diagnostics also precede this paper (Sornette et al., 2023). These comparisons exclude first-use claims. Independent assessment of the importance and novelty of this particular connection remains necessary.

2.4 A Financially Specified Probe Account

A probe changes inventory as well as price. We therefore specify actual cash and execution timing, rather than treating a fixed price exposure as its complete financial loss. Price has units of currency per asset quantity, and κ has units of currency per squared quantity.

Lemma 2.6 (Positive price-response geometry and fair execution)**.** *In the positive, stable, price-first cohort economy, the physical execution-to-price impulse response is a nonnegative mixture of decaying exponentials:*

$$h_j = \sum_{\ell} w_\ell \lambda_\ell^j, \qquad w_\ell \geq 0, \quad \sum_{\ell} w_\ell = \kappa, \quad 0 \leq \lambda_\ell < 1.$$

It is completely monotone and nonincreasing. In particular its peak is direct impact κ, even when the full transition is non-normal in its original coordinates.

In the declared price/memory coordinates, a fixed price-only operator $C = \lambda e_x^\top$ also has initial-state gain $\sup_{t\geq 0} \|CJ^t\|_2 = |\lambda|$. Thus full-state non-normal amplification cannot by itself establish a transient loss in this particular monetary price-only experiment.

For a quote schedule refreshed after the uncontrolled state update, execution at the average price of a linear book gives cost relative to the constant fundamental mark

$$\mathcal{C}(v) = \frac{1}{2} v^\top T_h v, \qquad (T_h)_{ij} = h_{|i-j|}.$$

The matrix is positive definite, so no nonzero signed roundtrip produces a deterministic gain under this fill/noise contract. Nonnegative execution fees add cost.

Proof. Omit zero-weight cohorts, which do not affect price. For $a > 0$, put $b_i = \kappa q_i$, $r_i = 1-\eta_i$ and

$$T = \operatorname{diag}(\sqrt{a}, \sqrt{b_1/\eta_1}, \ldots), \qquad v = (\sqrt{a}, \sqrt{b_1\eta_1}, \ldots)^\top.$$

The transformed transition is the symmetric positive-definite matrix

$$J' = TJT^{-1} = \operatorname{diag}(0, r_1, \ldots) + vv^\top.$$

The input transforms to $TH = \kappa v$ and $J'e_x = \sqrt{a}\, v$. Consequently,

$$h_j = (\kappa/a) e_x^\top (J')^{j+1} e_x.$$

Spectral decomposition gives the claimed nonnegative weights, whose sum is $h_0 = \kappa$. Schur stability puts the eigenvalues below one. The case $a = 0$ follows by continuity from positive anchors, with the same uniformly stable rate family; the zero-feedback case is simply $h_j = \kappa a^j$. This also covers repeated rates after merging.

The nonnegative transition has row sums at most one. Hence every price row of J^t has ℓ_1 norm at most one, and therefore ℓ_2 norm at most one. Time zero attains one, proving the fixed price-only gain statement. Its initial-state geometry is specified; coordinate changes require transforming that set.

After the uncontrolled update, the pre-probe displacement at step j is $\sum_{i<j} h_{j-i} v_i$. Average linear-book execution adds $\kappa v_j/2$. Summing signed execution cost gives the displayed Toeplitz quadratic form. Each kernel $\lambda^{|i-j|}$ is a positive-definite AR(1) covariance matrix for

$0 \le \lambda < 1$. Their nonnegative mixture with positive total weight is positive definite. For a roundtrip $\sum v_j = 0$, the fundamental-price cash term cancels, so a positive execution cost excludes a gain. □

Theorem 2.7 (Sharp robust quantity cap from cash and margin)**.** *Use that positive, stable, reset economy with constant fundamental price $P_* > 0$ and no process noise. At step t, first update the uncontrolled baseline $z^0_{t+1} = Jz_t$, with price $P^0_{t+1} = P_* + e_x^\top z^0_{t+1}$. A designated dealer fills only controlled nonnegative probes $v_t \ge 0$ on a linear quote schedule, at average price $P^0_{t+1} + \kappa v_t/2$. Other market flow is executed elsewhere. The final state is $z_{t+1} = z^0_{t+1} + Hv_t$ and the final mark is $P_{t+1} = P_* + x_{t+1}$. Initially inventory is zero and cash/equity is $B > 0$. Each fill costs cv_t, $c \ge 0$, with no other positions, fees or funding flows:*

$$I_{t+1} = I_t - v_t, \quad K_{t+1} = K_t + v_t(P^0_{t+1} + \kappa v_t/2) - cv_t, \quad E_t = K_t + I_t P_t.$$

For fixed margin $\mu > 0$, require $\mu|I_t|P_t \le E_t$. For the robust contract admitting every nonnegative probe sequence with $\sum_t v_t \le V$, the largest quantity allowance guaranteeing margin at every time is exactly

$$V_B = \frac{2B}{\beta + \sqrt{\beta^2 + 4(\mu + 1/2)\kappa B}}, \qquad \beta = c + \mu P_*. \tag{24}$$

Equivalently, the necessary and sufficient robust condition is

$$(\mu + 1/2)\kappa V^2 + (c + \mu P_*)V \le B. \tag{25}$$

The cap holds across all positive cohort representations satisfying $S < 1$, without resolving individual adaptation rates.

For the known symmetric testing pair and the declared deterministic probes, suppose the statistical observer receives only noisy price-state observations and executed quantities, without exact execution-price, cash or equity records. Its best finite-horizon error within this robust quantity allowance is exactly $\Phi[-V_B\|d_T\|_2/(2\sigma)]$. Holding the other primitives fixed, achieving a fixed error $\alpha < 1/2$ requires capital of order at least δ^{-4} under this observation/probing contract, and a single positive pulse attains that order. This capital order is distinct from the average-power horizon order and does not bound every tailored safe, hedged

or adaptive experiment or richer financial disclosure.

Proof. Let $U_t = \sum_{j<t} v_j$. Positive impulse responses give $0 \le x_t \le \kappa U_t$ and $I_t = -U_t$. Summing actual cash and marking inventory gives

$$B - E_t = U_t x_t - \sum_{j<t} v_j x^0_{j+1} - \frac{\kappa}{2} \sum_{j<t} v_j^2 + cU_t.$$

Write its quadratic terms as $v^\top A_t v$. The diagonal entry for probe i is $h_{t-1-i} - \kappa/2$. For $i < j$, the off-diagonal entry is

$$(A_t)_{ij} = \tfrac{1}{2}\{h_{t-1-i} + h_{t-1-j} - h_{j-i}\}.$$

Monotonicity and $t - 1 - i \ge j - i$ imply that every off-diagonal entry is at most $\kappa/2$; the diagonals satisfy the same bound. Therefore $B - E_t \le \kappa U_t^2/2 + cU_t \le \kappa V^2/2 + cV$. Position value is bounded by $U_t(P_* + x_t) \le V(P_* + \kappa V)$. Condition (25) guarantees margin and positive equity/marks. During a nonnegative linear-book fill, the adverse mark and position value worsen monotonically, so the endpoint check also covers intermediate fills. Without a fill, monotone positive impulse decay improves the short probe-only account's mark.

A single reset pulse gives $x_1 = \kappa V$, $I_1 = -V$ and $E_1 = B - \kappa V^2/2 - cV$, simultaneously attaining both adverse bounds. Any larger quantity allowance fails at that first response. Solving the quadratic in a form avoiding subtraction cancellation gives (24).

The first positive pulse also attains the statistical convolution-column bound. The quantity lower bound requires $V_B \ge c_\alpha \delta^{-2}$, so (25) requires $B \ge (\mu + 1/2)\kappa c_\alpha^2 \delta^{-4}$. The third-observation pulse A in (22), funded with $B = (\mu + 1/2)\kappa A^2 + (c + \mu P_*)A$, meets margin and attains error α, proving the matching order. □

Quadratic impact costs and execution timing are established microstructure issues (Almgren and Chriss, 2001); this paper proposes their connection to a particular memory-testing and robust margin contract. Even with initial inventory zero, the probe creates a quadratic adverse mark. A fixed initial price exposure would miss it. The refreshed average-fill convention is imposed, not an estimated competitive equilibrium or real fill calibration. The capital comparison assumes validity of the linear response over growing probes; fixed model-validity or position limits add a resolution floor. Uncertain impact, process shocks, other inventory,

funding and collateral rules require an expanded account. Anonymous VAR estimates do not authenticate its physical κ.

Proposition 2.8 (Exact financial disclosure changes the experiment)**.** *In this noiseless-state account, exact disclosure of the third equity mark after a single positive reset pulse A distinguishes the known symmetric pair with zero error for every $\delta > 0$. The pulse can be any $0 < A \leq V_B$.*

Proof. The initial cash receipt is common to both alternatives, and the dealer subsequently holds inventory $-A$. At time three,

$$E_{3,r} = B + \kappa A^2/2 - cA - A^2 h_{r,2}.$$

The exact tap difference gives $E_{3,\delta} - E_{3,0} = A^2\kappa^2 q\delta^2 > 0$. Exact equity disclosure therefore determines which known alternative generated the path. No Gaussian price-observation test is involved, and the admissible positive pulse can be arbitrarily small. □

Exact marked equity is extra information, not a free observation assumed in the price-only theorem. Real account marks, executions and fees have their own precision and model error. The counterexample prevents interpreting the capital order as a universal limit for an account owner who receives richer financial records.

2.5 Capital Paid by the Probe Trader

The counterparty's margin allowance and the probe trader's funding are different accounts. The next result uses the actual cost borne by the trader, rather than inferring a universal capital limit from an imposed total-quantity ball.

Theorem 2.9 (Matching capital order for funded deterministic probes)**.** *Use the same positive, stable, reset economy and refreshed average linear-book execution law, with no process noise. The statistical observer receives only the declared noisy price-state observations and known executed quantities. Exact execution prices, cash, inventory marks and other noiseless financial signals are not disclosed to that observer.*

The probe trader starts with cash/equity $B > 0$ and inventory zero. A deterministic finite sequence of signed quantities v changes its inventory by $+v_t$ and cash by

$$K_{t+1} = K_t - v_t(P^0_{t+1} + \kappa v_t/2) - c|v_t|, \qquad c \geq 0.$$

Thereafter quantities stop and the trader must remain solvent as price returns to $P_* > 0$. Let all relevant true prices be positive. For the symmetric known pair with rates at least ϵ from the endpoints, put

$$r = 1 - \epsilon(1 - S) < 1, \qquad m = \kappa\frac{1-r}{1+r} > 0, \qquad K_* = \frac{2\kappa^2 q}{\epsilon^3(1-S)^2}.$$

Every such solvent strategy satisfies

$$D_{\mathrm{KL}}(P^v_0 \| P^v_\delta) \leq \frac{K_*^2 B\delta^4}{\sigma^2 m}. \tag{26}$$

Hence worst-case error at most $\alpha < 1/2$ requires

$$B \geq \frac{2\sigma^2 m(1-2\alpha)^2}{K_*^2\delta^4}. \tag{27}$$

This applies without a total-quantity cap and with any finite observation horizon.

Conversely, for any fixed margin fraction $0 < \mu \leq 1$, the positive reset pulse A in (22) achieves error α at the third observation and remains margin-solvent at every later mark when its trader capital is

$$B_A = \frac{\kappa}{2}A^2 + (c + \mu P_*)A. \tag{28}$$

Thus necessary and sufficient capital orders are δ^{-4} in this deterministic experiment with no process noise and a restricted observer. Counterparty funding can additionally be supplied by (25) and has the same order. Neither result applies unchanged to richer disclosure or natural excitation.

Proof. Let $I_T = \sum_t v_t$. Summing actual trader cash and marking the residual inventory at the limiting price P_* gives

$$E_\infty = B - \tfrac{1}{2}v^\top T_h v - c\sum_t |v_t|.$$

Solvency requires $E_\infty \geq 0$. For each exponential mode $\lambda \leq r$, the Toeplitz kernel has spectral density

$$f_\lambda(\omega) = \frac{1-\lambda^2}{1-2\lambda\cos\omega+\lambda^2} \geq \frac{1-r}{1+r}.$$

Fourier integration of the finite probe polynomial and the positive mixture weights therefore gives $v^\top T_h v \geq m\|v\|_2^2$. Consequently $\|v\|_2^2 \leq 2B/m$. The transfer-difference bound of Theorem 2.5 gives Gaussian mean-difference squared norm at most $K_*^2\delta^4\|v\|_2^2$, including zero-padded observations after probing stops. Equal-noise KL proves (26); Pinsker and the two-point error requirement prove (27).

For one positive pulse, cash becomes $B_A - A(P_* + \kappa A/2) - cA$ and inventory is A. At any subsequent mark,

$$E_t = \mu A P_* + A^2 h_{t-1}, \qquad \mu|I_t|P_t = \mu A P_* + \mu A^2 h_{t-1}.$$

Because $h_j \geq 0$ and $\mu \leq 1$, margin holds, including its limiting fundamental mark. True prices remain at least P_*. The known-pair third-observation test has error α, and A has order δ^{-2}, so (28) has order δ^{-4}. □

The lower bound uses solvency after temporary impact dissipates. It does not credit self-generated temporary price appreciation as permanent funding. The financial model permits a margin loan and assumes no holding interest, other positions or fundamental-price risk. Fixed model-validity and position limits constrain the attainable pulse. These assumptions and the observer's restricted information must accompany the capital interpretation.

2.6 A Constructive Boundary: Natural Excitation Supplies Information

The fixed-quantity information limit is not universal for naturally excited markets. The following example shows precisely why the no-process-noise assumption matters.

Proposition 2.10 (Passive distinction with zero controlled quantity)**.** *Keep the same known symmetric cohort pair, but add independent uniform price innovations $w_t \in [-b, b]$, $b > 0$, of variance $s_w^2 = b^2/3$ at each price update, followed by the price-first memory update. Observe the centered price state $\tilde{x}_t = x_t + \nu_t$, with independent Gaussian noise of variance*

σ^2. *Consider independent three-step reset blocks and no controlled probes, with* $P_* > 3b$ *so actual price marks remain positive. Write*

$$b_1 = a + \kappa q\eta, \qquad b_{2,0} = b_1^2 + \kappa q\eta(1-\eta), \qquad b_{2,\delta} = b_{2,0} - \kappa q\delta^2.$$

For each block, the covariance of its first and third noisy price observations differs by $\Delta = \kappa q s_w^2 \delta^2$. *Let*

$$R = \max_{r\in\{0,\delta\}} \left\{ (s_w^2+\sigma^2)[s_w^2(1+b_1^2+b_{2,r}^2)+\sigma^2] + s_w^4 b_{2,r}^2 \right\}.$$

The midpoint test of the average product of those two observations has worst-case error at most α *whenever* $n \geq 4R/(\alpha\Delta^2)$ *independent blocks are observed. Thus this experiment can distinguish the pair with controlled quantity zero and order* δ^{-4} *passive blocks. The designated probe-only dealer has inventory zero and equity* B *throughout.*

Proof. In each block $x_1 = w_1$, $x_2 = b_1 w_1 + w_2$ and $x_3 = b_{2,r} w_1 + b_1 w_2 + w_3$. The positive process impulse coefficients are at most one, so $|x_t| \leq 3b$ in the block. Independent observation noise changes marginal variances but not the covariance $s_w^2 b_{2,r}$. The product variance equals the product of marginal variances plus squared covariance, with an additional fourth-cumulant term $b_{2,r}^2(Ew_1^4 - 3s_w^4)$. Uniform innovations have fourth cumulant $-2b^4/15$, so this term is nonpositive and the variance is bounded by R. The variance of the independent-block average is at most R/n. Its two means are separated by Δ, so Chebyshev bounds either midpoint-test error by $4R/(n\Delta^2)$. No controlled fill occurs, hence the stated probe-only account has no inventory or trading cost. □

Independent resets and known innovations are extra information conditions, not assumptions verified in the empirical samples. This counterexample does not prove that anonymous public records identify participants. It shows that passive process excitation can accumulate memory information even when controlled quantity and the designated account's capital remain fixed. Reset costs, other exposures and unknown noise laws would change that experiment. The paper's capital and quantity conclusions consequently belong to their declared controlled contracts.

Proposition 2.11 (Conditional Quote and Allocation Cost of Ambiguity)**.** *Consider a fixed one-unit ticket with monetary adverse mark* $Z_\theta \sim N(\mu_\theta, \sigma_\theta^2)$ *and a CARA dealer of risk aversion* $\gamma > 0$. *Let* $c_\theta = \mu_\theta + \gamma\sigma_\theta^2/2$ *and suppose* $c_\theta \geq 0$ *with* $\sup_{\theta\in\Theta} c_\theta < \infty$. *Under*

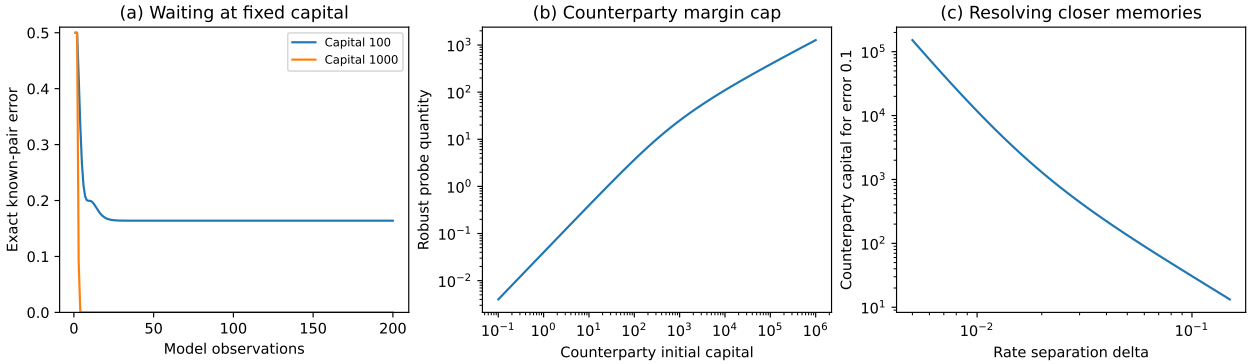


Figure 1: Constructed known-pair experiment funded by the counterparty cash/margin contract. Panel(a) gives exact Gaussian error at fixed counterparty capital 100 and 1,000, with separation0.05. Panel(b) gives the sharp robust quantity allowance. Panel(c) gives required capital within that counterparty quantity-ball contract for error 0.1 with 200 observations. Parameters are $a = 0.5, \kappa = 0.8, q = 0.2, \eta = 0.4$, observation SD 0.003, reference price100, margin 0.25 and cost 0.02. Quotes refresh after the uncontrolled update and executions pay half their direct impact. There is no process noise. These are imposed model units and fills. This plot does not give globally optimal probe-trader capital constants.

competition imposing zero robust certainty equivalent, the informed quote is $s_1 = c_{\theta_0}$ *and the ambiguous quote is* $s_2 = \sup_\theta c_\theta$ *for* $\theta_0 \in \Theta$. *Thus* $\Delta = s_2 - s_1 \geq 0$, *with strict inequality precisely when the worst relevant cost exceeds* c_{θ_0}. *Cohort nonidentification alone does not establish that condition or proportionality to a parameter diameter.*

Under an additional allocation-surplus criterion with inverse demand $v(V) = (V_0 - V)/b$ *and fixed marginal cost* c, *raising an interior quote from* s_0 *to* $s_0 + \Delta$ *produces surplus difference*

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{loss}} = b(s_0 - c)\Delta + \frac{b}{2}\Delta^2.$$

The triangle formula requires the efficient baseline $s_0 = c$. *Treating a risk charge as a social cost requires a defended welfare criterion.*

Proof. Gaussian CARA certainty equivalent is $s - c_\theta$; its infimum is $s - \sup_\theta c_\theta$. The quote formulas follow from robust break-even. Equal costs throughout an observational equivalence class give zero premium. Integrating $v(V) - c$ between $V_0 - b(s_0 + \Delta)$ and $V_0 - bs_0$ gives the stated surplus formula. Parameter coordinate rescaling can change a diameter while leaving costs and quotes unchanged. □

The set of relevant adverse-mark costs is an additional economic primitive; the aggregate cohort-equivalence theorem does not determine it. Likewise, a norm radius $B/\sup_\theta M_C(J_\theta)$ concerns a declared initial-state loss experiment and is not a quantity of posted depth. The empirical existence and magnitude of an ambiguity-induced liquidity or welfare effect remain open.

2.7 Theorem 2: A Finite-Window Price-Surveillance Bound

The following experiment isolates a statistical boundary under passive price observations. Its parameter s is the scalar transition coefficient, distinct from the algebraic index $S = a+Q$ of a general multivariate market. Applying the result to a hidden multivariate market requires a valid observation-law reduction; no such reduction is inferred solely from a common unit-root boundary.

Theorem 2.12 (Finite-Window Abstention in a Scalar Gaussian Experiment)**.** *Observe* $\mathcal{D}_T = (x_1, \dots, x_T)$ *where* $x_0 = 0$ *and* $x_t = sx_{t-1} + w_t$, $w_t \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2)$ *independently,* $\sigma > 0$, *and* $s \in (0, 2)$. *Let a possibly randomized rule* Ψ *take values Stable, Unstable, or Abstain, with*

$$\sup_{s<1} P_s(\Psi = \text{Unstable}) \le \alpha, \qquad \sup_{s\ge 1} P_s(\Psi = \text{Stable}) \le \alpha, \quad 0 < \alpha < 1/2.$$

Choose $0 < c_0 < 1$ *with* $c_0 e^{c_0}/(2\sqrt{2}) < 1 - 2\alpha$. *For every integer* $T \ge 1$, *on* $\mathcal{B}_T = (1 - c_0/T, 1 + c_0/T)$,

$$\inf_{s\in\mathcal{B}_T} P_s(\Psi = \text{Abstain}) \ge 1 - 2\alpha - \frac{c_0 e^{c_0}}{2\sqrt{2}} > 0. \tag{29}$$

For every finite T, *the minimax worst-case error of binary rules across* $s \in (0, 2)$ *is at least* $1/2$.

Proof. Pair any $s_0 \in (1 - c_0/T, 1)$ with $s_1 = s_0 + c_0/T \in (1, 1 + c_0/T)$; reverse the pairing for a point on the other side, including $s_1 = 1$. Gaussian transition densities give

$$D_{\mathrm{KL}}(P_{s_0} \| P_{s_1}) = \frac{(s_1 - s_0)^2}{2\sigma^2} \sum_{t=1}^{T} E_{s_0} x_{t-1}^2.$$

For either paired coefficient, $|s| \le 1 + c_0/T$ and $E_s x_{t-1}^2 = \sigma^2 \sum_{j=0}^{t-2} s^{2j} \le \sigma^2 (t-1) e^{2c_0}$. Thus the KL divergence in either direction is at most $c_0^2 e^{2c_0}/4$ and Pinsker's inequality bounds

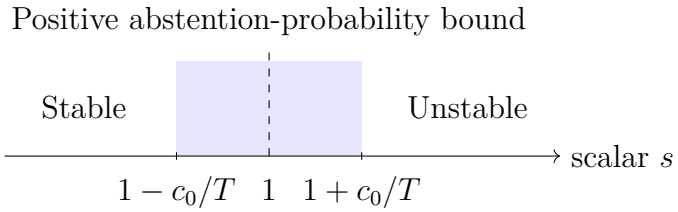


Figure 2: Illustrative scalar Gaussian boundary under uniform error control. The shaded interval has a positive lower bound on abstention probability, rather than requiring every observed path to abstain. It is not a universal boundary for richer observation contracts.

total variation by $c_0 e^{c_0}/(2\sqrt{2})$. Error control gives $P_{s_0}(\text{Unstable}) \leq \alpha$ and $P_{s_0}(\text{Stable}) \leq P_{s_1}(\text{Stable}) + \text{TV} \leq \alpha + \text{TV}$, yielding the stated abstention bound. The reverse pairing is identical.

For binary rules, the Gaussian path densities are continuous in s in total variation at each finite T. Let $s^- \uparrow 1$ and $s^+ \downarrow 1$. Le Cam's two-point bound gives worst-case error at least $(1 - \|P_{s^-} - P_{s^+}\|_{\text{TV}})/2 \to 1/2$. This is a worst-case statement over arbitrarily close alternatives; it is not a 50% error claim at every fixed separated parameter. □

The theorem forces a positive probability of withholding a classification under the specified uniform error guarantee. It does not require abstention on every sample path. Initial conditions, extra measurements, and observation noise can change the inference problem. In particular, a fully observed noiseless cohort recursion need not admit the common Lebesgue densities assumed by an informal reduction to a scalar price likelihood. The exact-disclosure supplement gives a constructive two-step identification result under an exact single-cohort state/demand contract. Thus observing aggregate demand as well as the true price state can change the statistical experiment and defeat a universal extension of the scalar bound.

2.8 Financial Intermediary Solvency and Non-Normal Transient Amplification

We now confront the fundamental divergence between price stability and financial intermediary solvency. In standard economic policy models, market stability is evaluated exclusively through the spectral radius $\rho(J) < 1$. We demonstrate that this criterion is dangerously incomplete.

The Non-Normal Market Jacobian. Consider the closed-loop Jacobian matrix J from (14). In financial markets, price impact and memory adaptation are asymmetric: order flow directly affects prices through contemporaneous impact κ, while price innovations affect memory through learning rate η. As a result, $JJ^\top - J^\top J \neq 0$: the closed-loop market Jacobian J is generically **non-normal** under asymmetric price-impact and learning parameters (except on a measure-zero algebraic subvariety). While normal matrices have orthogonal eigenvectors that diagonalize under unitary transformations, non-normal matrices have non-orthogonal (nearly parallel) eigenvectors. Consequently, even when all eigenvalues are strictly inside the unit circle ($|\lambda_i(J)| \leq \rho(J) < 1$), matrix powers J^t can undergo massive transient amplification before decaying asymptotically as $t \to \infty$ (Trefethen and Embree, 2005).

Optimizing Market Maker Problem and the Commitment Trap. To microfound the intermediary's financial vulnerability, we model a risk-averse, competitive market maker operating in continuous electronic order books (Ho and Stoll, 1981; Grossman and Miller, 1988; Avellaneda and Stoikov, 2008; Menkveld, 2013). At each instant, the dealer quotes bid and ask prices (or an effective price-impact schedule κ and half-spread s_t) to maximize expected inventory-adjusted fee revenue:

$$\max_{s_t, D_t} \mathbb{E}_t \left[\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \beta^k \left(s_{t+k}|q_{t+k}| - \frac{\phi}{2} I_{t+k}^2 \right) \right], \tag{30}$$

subject to inventory dynamics $I_{t+1} = I_t - q_t$, where q_t is aggressive incoming order flow, $\phi > 0$ represents the inventory holding penalty, and $\beta \in (0, 1)$ is the discount factor.

The market maker is subject to two institutional market design frictions:

1. **Regulatory Capital and Margin Requirements:** The dealer maintains equity capital E_t subject to a maximum regulatory leverage constraint or margin haircut $\mu \in (0, 1)$ on inventory positions: $\mu|I_t|p_t \leq E_t$, with equity evolving as $E_{t+1} = E_t + \Pi_t$, where $\Pi_t = s_t|q_t| + (I_t - q_t)(p_{t+1} - p_t) - f_t - g_t$ is trading P&L. Positive q_t denotes a dealer sale at the current midpoint plus signed spread; f_t, g_t are monetary fees and funding charges. This follows from cash $C_{t+1} = C_t + q_t p_t + s_t|q_t| - f_t - g_t$ and inventory $I_{t+1} = I_t - q_t$, marked at p_{t+1}.
2. **Execution Latency and Affirmative Quoting Commitments:** Registered market makers face regulatory affirmative obligations (spread caps $\bar{s}$ and minimum depth

commitments $\underline{D}$ required by exchange rules) and high-frequency cancellation latency $\tau_{\text{cancel}} > 0$. Once resting limit orders are posted in the order book, they remain committed for the cancellation latency window.

The dynamic objective requires a demand/fill law and a financially specified continuation state before its optimal depth can be solved. The initial available monetary capital and a declared model loss budget satisfy

$$A_0 = E_0 - \mu|I_0|p_0, \qquad 0 < B \le A_0. \tag{31}$$

This choice alone does not ensure future margin feasibility. The former division by $1 + \phi/\mu$ lacked a unit-consistent shadow-cost derivation.

Lemma 2.13 (Conditional Capacity Choice and Depth-Dependent Stability)**.** *For a static capacity illustration, fix net execution edge $r \ge 0$, holding coefficient $h > 0$, capital per quantity $m > 0$, and bounds $L_{\min} \le L \le L_{\max}$. Maximize $rL - hL^2/2$ subject to $mL \le A$. If $\bar{L} = \min(L_{\max}, A/m) < L_{\min}$, the quoting commitment is infeasible. Otherwise*

$$L^* = \min\{\bar{L}, \max(L_{\min}, r/h)\}, \qquad D^* = L^*/w, \quad \kappa^* = w/L^* \quad (L^* > 0), \tag{32}$$

where $w > 0$ is a declared linear-book price width. Capital raises capacity weakly; nonbinding capital changes leave capacity unchanged. This is a solved one-period illustration with fixed primitives, rather than a solution of the preceding dynamic dealer objective.

For one cohort, fixed $\varphi > 0$ and $0 < \eta < 1$, substituting $a = 1 - \kappa\varphi$ into the cohort transition gives Schur stability precisely when

$$q < \varphi, \qquad 0 < \kappa < \frac{4 - 2\eta}{(2 - \eta)\varphi - \eta q}.$$

Higher impact changes both persistence and coupling and does not necessarily increase transient magnification.

Proof. Strict concavity gives the unconstrained optimum r/h; projection onto the feasible interval gives L^*. The depth/impact relation is the declared clearing schedule. The three Jury quantities are $\kappa\eta(\varphi - q)$, $4 - 2\eta - \kappa[(2 - \eta)\varphi - \eta q]$, and $\eta + (1 - \eta)\kappa\varphi$, which yield the stated stability conditions.

For an exact counterexample, fix $\varphi = 1, q = 1/10, \eta = 9/10$. At $\kappa = 1/10$, the first column of J is $(9/10, 81/100)^\top$ and its squared norm is $14661/10000 > 1$. At $\kappa = 1$, $J = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 0 & 1/10 \\ 0 & 19/100 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ has squared operator norm $461/10000 < 1$. Both are stable. In the fixed all-state Euclidean experiment, the former has peak magnification greater than one, while the latter has peak one. Thus increasing impact can reduce transient risk in the stated model. □

The Solvency Trap: Why doesn't the optimizing dealer step away or widen spreads before non-normal amplification hits? Doing so violates exchange affirmative obligations (risking forfeiture of market-maker status and exchange fee rebates) or cedes order flow to Bertrand competitors. Furthermore, when an aggressive algorithmic feedback cascade arrives within the cancellation window τ_{cancel}, resting passive limit orders are executed against at stale quotes before the dealer can cancel or widen spreads (Budish, Cramton, and Shim, 2015). The following theorem concerns a declared model loss output $\ell_t = Cz_t$, $z_t = J^t z_0$, with C in the same monetary budget units as B. Actual cash, post-trade inventory, prices, fees, funding and margin changes must justify that output mapping. It does not follow from setting inventory equal to a latent-state norm. The model loss-budget breach is $\sup_{t\geq 0} |CJ^t z_0| > B$; operational solvency requires the additional accounting contract.

Theorem 2.14 (Conditional Loss Budget and Kreiss Bounds)**.** *Let $z_t = J^t z_0$ with $\rho(J) < 1$, balance-sheet buffer $B > 0$, and observation matrix C.*

1. ***Exact Worst-Case Safe Radius:*** *For the declared criterion $\sup_t \|CJ^t z_0\|_2 \leq B$, the exact maximum initial-state radius is:*

$$r^*_{exact} = \frac{B}{\sup_{t\geq 0} \|CJ^t\|_2} \equiv \frac{B}{M_C}, \tag{33}$$

   where $M_C \equiv \sup_{t\geq 0} \|CJ^t\|_2$ is the declared output gain. If $C = 0$, the allowance is unbounded by this criterion; actual financial constraints still apply.

2. ***Kreiss Lower and Upper Bounds:*** *Under full state observation ($C = I$), the Kreiss constant of matrix J, defined on the resolvent outside the unit disk:*

$$\mathcal{K}(J) \equiv \sup_{|z|>1} (|z| - 1)\|(zI - J)^{-1}\|_2, \tag{34}$$

satisfies $\mathcal{K}(J) \le \sup_{t\ge 0} \|J^t\|_2 \le e \cdot n \cdot \mathcal{K}(J)$ *for any* $J \in \mathbb{R}^{n\times n}$. *Consequently:*

$$r_{conservative} \equiv \frac{B}{e \cdot n \cdot \mathcal{K}(J)} \le r^*_{exact} \le \frac{B}{\mathcal{K}(J)}. \tag{35}$$

3. ***Complete Failure of Spectral Radius:*** *For any stable spectral radius* $\rho \in (0,1)$ *and any arbitrarily small buffer* $B > 0$, *there exists a parameter family of non-normal matrices* J_θ *and an observation operator* $C = [1, 0]$ *exposed to the amplified coordinate such that* $\rho(J_\theta) = \rho$ *for all* θ, *while the exact safe radius collapses to zero:*

$$\lim_{\theta\to\infty} r^*_{exact}(J_\theta) = 0. \tag{36}$$

Proof Sketch. Part 1 follows from the Cauchy–Schwarz inequality for operator norms: maximum loss across $\|z_0\|_2 \le r$ is $r \cdot \sup_{t\ge 0} \|CJ^t\|_2 = rM_C$, yielding $r^*_{\text{exact}} = B/M_C$. Part 2 applies Spijker's (1991) optimal resolution of the Kreiss matrix conjecture, establishing $\mathcal{K}(J) \le \sup_{t\ge 0} \|J^t\|_2 \le e \cdot n \cdot \mathcal{K}(J)$ for $C = I$. Part 3 uses $J_\theta = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} \rho & \theta \\ 0 & \rho \end{smallmatrix}\right)$. Then $CJ_\theta = (\rho, \theta)$, so $M_C \ge \sqrt{\rho^2 + \theta^2} \to \infty$. The family is defective; no eigenvector-basis argument is required. A complete proof is given in Internet Appendix IA.A. □

Remark 2.15 (Output and disturbance geometry). The theorem applies to a specified initial-state ball and output norm. State coordinate changes require a corresponding change in the disturbance set; arbitrary latent-state units cannot be interpreted as monetary losses. A physical execution-input experiment has a different gain, as Theorem 2.5 shows. The Kreiss lower radius concerns full-state observation. A small spectral radius alone supplies no universal bound, but non-normality alone does not establish severe monetary losses in a calibrated market.

Internet Appendix IA.B illustrates the same separation geometrically: for a constructed matrix with spectral radius 0.5, pseudospectral contours cross the unit circle.

2.9 Multi-Asset Generalization and Cross-Impact Kreiss Inflation

Modern market makers operate simultaneously across multiple correlated instruments (e.g., BTC, ETH, and altcoins; or equity index components and ETFs). In multi-asset environments, cross-asset price impact creates additional non-normal coupling.

Let $\mathbf{x}_t \in \mathbb{R}^d$ denote the vector of pricing errors across d traded assets, and let $\mathbf{u}_t \in \mathbb{R}^d$ denote aggregate order flows. The multi-asset price formation equation is:

$$\mathbf{x}_{t+1} = \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x}_t + \mathbf{K}\mathbf{u}_t + \mathbf{w}_{t+1}, \tag{37}$$

where $\mathbf{A} = \mathrm{diag}(a_1, \ldots, a_d) \in \mathbb{R}^{d\times d}$ collects direct price persistences, and $\mathbf{K} \in \mathbb{R}^{d\times d}$ is the cross-asset price impact matrix. For the following mathematical feedforward benchmark, allow $\mathbf{K}$ to be asymmetric. No causal instantaneous cross-asset impact matrix is calibrated here. A transactional interpretation additionally requires an execution-cost law consistent with no-price-manipulation restrictions; cross-impact symmetry under the relevant bounded-kernel assumptions is a substantive economic constraint (Schneider and Lillo, 2017).

Each asset is traded by adaptive momentum flow with learning rates $\mathbf{H} = \mathrm{diag}(\eta_1, \ldots, \eta_d)$ and feedback gain $\mathbf{Q} \in \mathbb{R}^{d\times d}$:

$$\mathbf{y}_{t+1} = (\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{H})\mathbf{y}_t + \mathbf{H}\mathbf{x}_{t+1}, \qquad \mathbf{u}_t = \mathbf{Q}\mathbf{y}_t. \tag{38}$$

Stacking $\mathbf{z}_t = (\mathbf{x}_t^\top, \mathbf{y}_t^\top)^\top \in \mathbb{R}^{2d}$, the multi-asset closed-loop Jacobian is:

$$J_{\text{multi}} = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{A} & \mathbf{KQ} \\ \mathbf{HA} & \mathbf{I} - \mathbf{H} + \mathbf{HKQ} \end{bmatrix} \in \mathbb{R}^{2d\times 2d}. \tag{39}$$

Proposition 2.16 (Cross-Impact Kreiss Inflation and Safe Radius Bound in Directed Networks)**.** *Consider a multi-asset economy with directed block-triangular leader-satellite cross-impact ($K_{12} = 0, K_{21} > 0$), diagonal feedback matrices $\mathbf{Q} \geq 0$, anchor matrices $\mathbf{A} \geq 0$, adaptation rates $\mathbf{H} \in (0,1)^d$, nonnegative impact matrix $\mathbf{K} \geq 0$, stable diagonal blocks, and fixed output operator $C \geq 0$. Let J_{diag} denote the decoupled Jacobian where $K_{21} = 0$. The directed coupling introduces off-diagonal block feedforward, inflating the Kreiss constant: $\mathcal{K}(J_{multi}) \geq \mathcal{K}(J_{diag})$. Consequently, the Kreiss-based conservative safe radius bound contracts: $r_{conservative}(J_{multi}) \equiv \frac{B}{e(2d)\mathcal{K}(J_{multi})} \leq r_{conservative}(J_{diag})$. For the exact safe shock radius $r^*_{exact}(J) \equiv B/M_C(J)$, because all constituent blocks of J are entrywise non-negative in the momentum economy, matrix powers J^t_{multi} are entrywise non-decreasing in K_{21}, yielding $M_C(J_{multi}) \geq M_C(J_{diag})$ and exact radius contraction $r^*_{exact}(J_{multi}) \leq r^*_{exact}(J_{diag})$. A fixed-coordinate constructed coupling can increase peak gain. Its magnitude requires a declared*

output and shock set; no empirical percentage follows from this proposition.

Proof. Permute coordinates by asset; directed impact makes the full transition block triangular, preserving the stable diagonal spectra. Entrywise $0 \leq J_{diag} \leq J_{multi}$ implies ordered nonnegative powers and ordered Euclidean operator norms after multiplication by fixed nonnegative C. For $r > 1$, the nonnegative Neumann series $(rI - J)^{-1} = \sum_{t \geq 0} J^t / r^{t+1}$ is likewise ordered. At any complex z with $|z| = r$, its modulus is entrywise bounded by this real-radius resolvent, so the norm supremum on that circle occurs at $z = r$. Taking the Kreiss supremum proves its monotonicity. The statements concern fixed coordinates and nonnegative output; signed hedge outputs need separate analysis. □

Proposition 2.16 concerns nonnegative downstream coupling under fixed shock/output geometry. Hedged or signed monetary outputs need separate treatment; they do not inherit a universal monotonic radius comparison. The earlier empirical 14.5-percent calibration claim is not established by this proof.

3 Data and Empirical Identification Strategy

3.1 Econometric Estimand and Moving-Average Filtering

We compute reduced-form indices under explicit price/flow constructions. Their algebra is invariant to consistent constant price and flow rescaling, but this does not identify structural learning or physical execution impact.

A fundamental gap between theoretical models and high-frequency empirical execution concerns the definition of the state variable. In theoretical models (Section 2), $x_t \equiv p_t - p_t^*$ represents price displacement relative to an unobserved fundamental value p_t^*. In empirical limit order books, true fundamental value is unobservable, and econometricians routinely replace p_t^* with a trailing price filter, such as an Exponential Moving Average (EMA).

Let p_b denote a log recorded-price proxy sampled at discrete uniform time bars b of length Δ (e.g., $\Delta = 10$ seconds). The trailing exponential moving-average anchor m_b is defined by the recursive filter:

$$m_b = (1 - \alpha) m_{b-1} + \alpha p_b, \qquad \alpha \equiv \frac{2}{W/\Delta + 1}, \tag{40}$$

where the proxy is transaction close for Binance trade bars and midpoint for the recorder. Multiplication of log prices by 10,000 changes their units, not the stated constant-scaling invariants. Here W is the smoothing window (e.g., $W = 300$ seconds, yielding $\alpha = 2/31 \approx 0.064516$). The empirical state variable is defined as the deviation from this trailing anchor:

$$x_b^{\mathrm{EMA}} \equiv p_b - m_b = (1-\alpha)(p_b - m_{b-1}) = \frac{1-\alpha}{1-(1-\alpha)L}\Delta p_b. \tag{41}$$

Proposition 3.1 (Mechanical Persistence under Filtered Random Walks)**.** *Suppose the log mid-price p_b follows an unpredictable martingale (random walk), such that $\mathbb{E}[p_{b+1} \mid \mathcal{F}_b] = p_b$. Then the moving-average deviation state x_b^{EMA} mechanically follows an autoregressive AR(1) process:*

$$\mathbb{E}[x_{b+1}^{EMA} \mid \mathcal{F}_b] = (1-\alpha)x_b^{EMA}, \tag{42}$$

with mechanical persistence parameter $a_0 \equiv 1-\alpha = \frac{29}{31} \approx 0.93548$.

Proof. By definition, $x_{b+1}^{\mathrm{EMA}} = p_{b+1} - m_{b+1} = (1-\alpha)(p_{b+1} - m_b)$. Conditioning on information $\mathcal{F}_b$:

$$\mathbb{E}[x_{b+1}^{\mathrm{EMA}} \mid \mathcal{F}_b] = (1-\alpha)\left(\mathbb{E}[p_{b+1} \mid \mathcal{F}_b] - m_b\right) = (1-\alpha)(p_b - m_b) = (1-\alpha)x_b^{\mathrm{EMA}}, \tag{43}$$

which establishes (42) with mechanical persistence $a_0 = 1-\alpha$. □

Remark 3.2 (Economic Interpretation of Empirical Feedback $\hat{Q}$). The EMA state measures deviation from a trailing price proxy rather than the unobserved fundamental value. In the corrected observed-flow panel, equal-weight pooled date means give $\hat{Q} = 0.0003807$ and $\hat{S} = 0.9203825$, hence the corresponding mean $\hat{J}_{11} = 0.9200018$. The mechanical martingale anchor is $29/31 \simeq 0.9354839$ for this filter. A smaller fitted coefficient is a descriptive comparison; it does not prove market-level fundamental stability, identify bid–ask bounce or inventory replenishment as its cause, or authenticate a structural feedback mechanism.

Let f_t denote the sample-specific flow feature. Binance uses notional taker buy volume minus taker sell volume over the observed bar; recorder features and quote OFI use the separately declared constructions. The empirical bivariate vector autoregressive (VAR(1))

representation of joint price-flow transitions is:

$$\begin{bmatrix} x_{t+1}^{\mathrm{EMA}} \\ f_{t+1} \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} J_{11} & J_{12} \\ J_{21} & J_{22} \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x_t^{\mathrm{EMA}} \\ f_t \end{bmatrix} + \begin{bmatrix} e_{1,t+1} \\ e_{2,t+1} \end{bmatrix}, \qquad \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{e}_t \mathbf{e}_t^\top] = \Sigma_e, \tag{44}$$

Here all J_{ij} are reduced-form coefficients for the constructed state and flow. They are not authenticated physical impact or latent learner parameters. When its denominators are nonzero, we extract dimensionless invariants $\hat{Q} \equiv \frac{\hat{J}_{12}\hat{J}_{21}}{1-\hat{J}_{22}}$, $\hat{S} \equiv \hat{J}_{11} + \hat{Q}$, and $\hat{\mathcal{L}} \equiv \frac{\hat{Q}}{1-\hat{J}_{11}}$, which are strictly scale-invariant.

3.2 Measurement Sensitivity: How Clocks and Filters Dominate Feedback

Table 2 reconstructs the measurement comparison from the existing BTC, ETH and ADA recorder caches. One-second records are aggregated into ten-second bins, with a 300-second trailing EMA. The preserved filter resets at gaps and continues across contiguous UTC dates; regressions and lags split at gaps and dates. This is a recorded-series diagnostic. Exact primary-source byte matching and uploader-declared CC0 are documented below; the economic interpretation of its recorded flow remains a separate question.

Table 2: Reconstructed recorded-series timing/state diagnostics. Mean Q and exploratory date-level Student intervals are based on 13 sampled dates; serial independence and universal coverage are not established. All three assets and constructions are retained.

Asset	State / clock	Dates	Transitions	Mean Q	Date interval
BTC	EMA / observed	13	102470	0.0019353	[0.00032, 0.00355]
BTC	EMA / forward	13	102454	0.0125227	[0.00653, 0.01851]
BTC	Return / observed	13	102470	0.0012059	[-0.00067, 0.00308]
ETH	EMA / observed	13	102771	0.0009795	[0.00006, 0.00190]
ETH	EMA / forward	13	102757	0.0113018	[0.00806, 0.01454]
ETH	Return / observed	13	102771	0.0003310	[-0.00035, 0.00101]
ADA	EMA / observed	13	102898	0.0006163	[0.00016, 0.00108]
ADA	EMA / forward	13	102885	0.0072058	[0.00564, 0.00877]
ADA	Return / observed	13	102898	0.0000018	[-0.00094, 0.00094]

The forward variant pairs the price state x_b with next-bin flow F_{b+1} rather than observed F_b, creating look-ahead information in the state pairing. It is not a separately authenticated

future 60-second execution window. The raw-return date intervals include zero for all three assets. The baseline recorder construction admits 75, 72 and 69 partial bins for BTC, ETH and ADA. A stricter sensitivity requires ten observed seconds and resets the EMA across resulting gaps: mean observed-EMA Q becomes 0.0010800, 0.0007072 and 0.0004148. Its ADA EMA interval spans zero; all three strict raw-return intervals also span zero. Every strict sample count, date estimate and interval is retained. The baseline covariance, switching and shuffle studies refer to their explicitly retained occupied-bin construction, rather than claiming complete-bin robustness. These results establish sensitivity to the declared timing and state construction; non-rejection does not establish absent learning or a universal explanation of market behavior. The earlier narrow HAC intervals, raw-return literals and SOL recorder label are not authenticated by these calculations and are replaced by the named result fields.

Controlling for Order-Splitting Memory. The diagnostic

$$Q_L = \hat{J}_{12}\hat{c}_L/(1 - \sum_{\ell=1}^{L} \hat{\phi}_\ell)$$

uses the regression F_{b+1} on $x_b, F_b, \ldots, F_{b-L+1}$. Here L counts bars, not seconds, and $L = 1$ recovers VAR(1). This is an observable long-run response functional; omitted fundamentals, endogenous flow, near-zero denominators and filtering can prevent a structural interpretation.

3.3 Covariance Restrictions and the Limits of Heteroskedastic Identification

For a stationary VAR, $\Gamma_0 = J\Gamma_0 J^\top + \Sigma$ and $\Gamma_k = J^k\Gamma_0$. Matching three contemporaneous and eight lagged covariance entries gives 11 moments and seven transition/noise parameters. Our diagnostic uses a full stable transition and positive-definite innovation parameterization, segment-aware moment HAC and six starts per declared case. All 24 cases (three assets, two centering rules and four bandwidths) reject their maintained restrictions under their stated asymptotic reference. For global centering and bandwidth ten bars, J statistics are 41.4063, 28.3094 and 12.1175 for BTC, ETH and ADA. These rejections do not validate the fitted

economic model. The earlier restricted-fit statistic 73 concerns a different parameter class and is retained only in the historical ledger.

Contemporaneous heteroskedastic identification additionally requires invariant structural coefficients, valid innovations, orthogonal structural shocks and a defended regime partition. Nonproportional variance shifts alone do not supply all of these. In the two-equation system, exchanging shock labels maps (λ, c) to $(1/c, 1/\lambda)$ while preserving each covariance after variance rescaling. Sign or economic exclusions can distinguish some branches, but the current source's single bounded numerical root is not an identification proof. Its forward-flow pairing and endogenous volatility grouping do not establish the required assumptions. Thus the old negative coefficient is not evidence that market makers provide identified instantaneous buffering. The exact branch-equivalence witness and all covariance sensitivities are retained.

3.4 Data Coverage, Representation and Authentication

The supplied data are different measurement objects. Official Binance trade bars have raw executed-volume fields; the recorder files contain supplied quote/flow features; the equity representation is event-indexed; the January file contains depth snapshots. Counts of these objects cannot be combined into a count of independent, continuous one-second transitions. The three recorder CSVs match the Nielsen version 1 provider release byte for byte, with provider archive CRC and full SHA256 checks. Its primary metadata declares CC0. The FI-2010 primary metadata declares CC BY 4.0; the local mirror licence does not supersede it. Its supplied transformation has been exactly replayed against independently retrieved normalized files; primary-archive hash, local company-label mapping and reconstructed physical scales remain unauthenticated. Current Binance Vision terms specify CC BY-NC-SA 4.0 for the downloaded data; the final derivative-release package must reflect the provider terms. The January CSV now also matches the original siavashraz version 1 CSV byte for byte (uploader-declared MIT). That provider describes Binance Bitcoin perpetual BTCUSDT.P data at nominal 250-millisecond sampling. The separately matched szh765 Parquet distribution declares Apache 2.0. These establish distribution identity and provider-declared venue/contract, rather than independent exchange authentication. Source metadata, hashes and licence texts accompany this revision.

The Binance reconstruction retains the first duplicate timestamp and requires all ten

Table 3: Exact working-sample coverage. Original-provider attribution and reuse permission are separate from local file hashes.

Sample	Coverage	Raw rows / representation	Source status
Binance spot	96 dates, 2021–2024	66,316,704 one-second bar rows	Current official checksums
Recorded BTC/ETH/ADA	April 7–19, 2021	Existing second-indexed feature files	Primary version 1 bytes matched
Supplied equity	50 legacy labels; 49 legacy fits	272,941 event snapshots	Mirror replay matched; mapping open
January BTC depth	January 9–20, 2023	3,730,870 raw snapshots	Primary distribution matched

observed seconds per primary bar. It resets the EMA at each gap and date, burns 150 ten-second states and estimates sufficiently long segments separately. There are 38,859 missing seconds and 363 duplicate seconds across the reconstructed study units, without conflicting duplicate rows. Legacy filling is reproduced solely to explain the original outputs. The recorder baseline admits occupied ten-second bins, including partial bins; its EMA resets at missing whole bins and continues across contiguous dates, while regressions split dates and those bin gaps. Consecutively repeated feature renders have their recorded flow set to zero under the archived deduplication rule; this reconstructs the cache but does not authenticate the underlying execution window. No universal winsorization or quote-filter percentage is asserted.

For quote OFI, a price increase contributes new bid size and a bid-price decrease removes old bid size; an unchanged bid contributes its size change. Ask signs reverse. Quote OFI is distinct from executed signed flow. The previous simplified price-indicator formula and claim that a depth proxy automatically purges endogeneity are not used.

4 Original Panel and Fee-Schedule Comparison

4.1 Baseline Reconstruction and Cross-Asset Measurement

The original panel is fully reconstructed at its 768 named study units using current official archives. Calendar Bartlett HAC sensitivity at 30, 90, 180 and 365-day bandwidths retains positive pooled observed-EMA reference intervals and raw-return intervals spanning zero.

Table 4: Original-panel measurement reconstruction: equal-weight means across assets within each of 96 sampled dates, followed by date means and exploratory Student intervals. The 768 study units contain 66,316,704 raw one-second rows; primary fits use 6,513,239 ten-second transitions. These are reduced-form diagnostics.

Construction	Q	Date interval	S	Date interval	$Q > 0$ share
Legacy forward-flow	0.0081536	[0.0072958, 0.0090114]	0.9205544	[0.9164297, 0.9246791]	86.85%
Observed-flow EMA	0.0003807	[0.0002412, 0.0005201]	0.9203825	[0.9160228, 0.9247423]	62.37%
Observed raw return	-0.0001625	[-0.0003836, 0.0000585]	-0.0414724	[-0.0517954, -0.0311494]	48.83%

Table 5: Original-panel asset means under explicit timing/state choices. Q_{30} controls 30 ten-second bars (300 seconds); it is a long-run regression diagnostic. No participant or regulatory causal effect is identified.

Pair	Days	Legacy Q	Observed Q	Q_{30}	Return Q	Observed S
BTC/USDT	96	0.0142386	0.0006350	0.0005751	0.0000594	0.9346384
ETH/USDT	96	0.0131252	0.0005657	0.0003358	-0.0005013	0.9349149
SOL/USDT	96	0.0087132	0.0002036	0.0001314	-0.0005210	0.9190796
ADA/USDT	96	0.0067986	0.0003953	0.0003623	0.0000840	0.9142432
DOGE/USDT	96	0.0059319	0.0002511	0.0001622	-0.0002345	0.9245799
BNB/USDT	96	0.0057950	0.0004587	0.0002731	-0.0000789	0.8946552
XRP/USDT	96	0.0057009	0.0002292	0.0001741	-0.0004279	0.9233588
LTC/USDT	96	0.0049256	0.0003068	0.0002650	0.0003200	0.9175903

These retrospective Gaussian references require additional mixing/stationarity assumptions; they do not establish causal or finite-sample coverage. All 32 index/measurement references accompany the revision. The large legacy positive estimate changes materially under observed-flow alignment; raw-return date intervals include zero for the pooled diagnostic. This is a measurement result, not a proof that learning is absent. A stable fitted VAR or $S < 1$ is not an authenticated structural stability statement about the market.

An additional dependence sensitivity aggregates the sampled date means into four equal-weight year means. The observed-flow EMA index has a t_3 reference interval [0.0001821, 0.0005793], while the raw-return interval is $[-0.0007691, 0.0004440]$. These references require approximately independent, comparable annual errors. Exact enumeration of the 16 annual sign patterns gives two-sided symmetry-reference values 0.125 and 0.500 respectively, under a different independent-symmetric-error assumption. Neither assumption is verified by four

years. The discrepancy between reference procedures prevents interpreting a selected small p-value as robust mechanism identification.

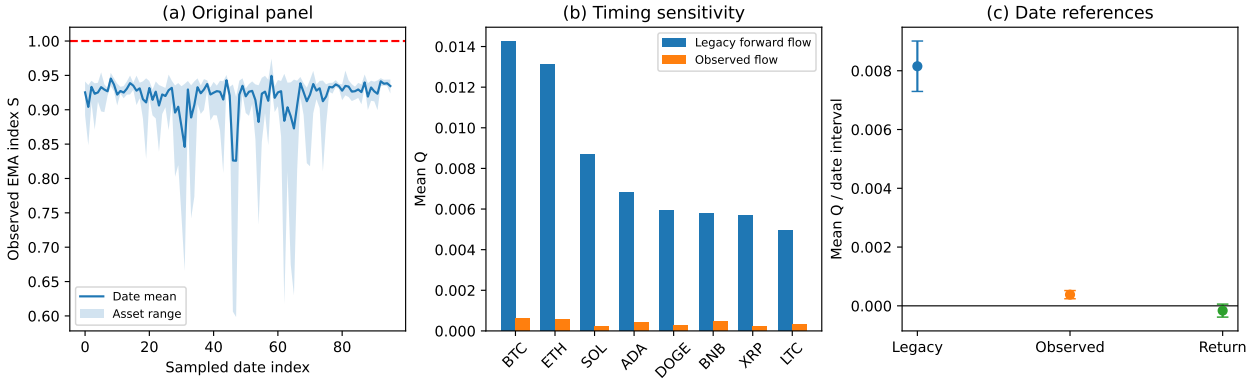


Figure 3: Reconstructed original panel: observed EMA index by date, legacy versus observed asset means, and pooled date-level uncertainty for three measurement constructions. Every panel uses the raw-reproduced study units. No identified market-maker buffering coefficient is plotted.

4.2 July 2022 Fee-Schedule Comparison and Inference

For the 24 sampled 2022 dates, fit

$$Y_{it} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \mathrm{BTC}_i + \beta_2 \mathrm{Post}_t + \beta_3 \mathrm{BTC}_i \mathrm{Post}_t + e_{it}.$$

Here post means dates on/after July 8. There are 192 rows and one treated asset. The reconstructed sampled-date mean BTC quote volume increases by 75.010858 percent; that descriptive difference is not a fee-induced causal estimate. Table 6 separates the actual covariance references instead of calling classical uncertainty clustered.

For observed Q, the date-cluster interval is $[-0.001025969, 0.000814559]$. Neither a non-rejection nor the cross-asset placebo ranking proves invariance or a parallel counterfactual. The old equivalence margin 0.007 is about 18 times the corrected pooled baseline; passing such a margin cannot establish economically meaningful equivalence. Asset comparisons are not random treatment reassignments. Serial dependence across sampled dates, spillovers and the single treated unit remain material inference limitations.

Table 6: Recomputed BTC-by-post association in the original 192-unit 2022 panel. The same four-regressor specification is evaluated under three covariance references; cluster counts are eight assets and 24 sampled dates. The assignment is not randomized.

State	Index	Reference	$\hat{\beta}_3$	SE	df	p
Legacy	Q	classical	-0.0018555	0.0030720	188	0.546569
Legacy	Q	asset cluster	-0.0018555	0.0008841	7	0.074018
Legacy	Q	date cluster	-0.0018555	0.0034116	23	0.591756
Legacy	S	classical	-0.0003897	0.0245851	188	0.987370
Legacy	S	asset cluster	-0.0003897	0.0195257	7	0.984634
Legacy	S	date cluster	-0.0003897	0.0132341	23	0.976763
Observed	Q	classical	-0.0001057	0.0004038	188	0.793794
Observed	Q	asset cluster	-0.0001057	0.0002139	7	0.636344
Observed	Q	date cluster	-0.0001057	0.0004449	23	0.814284
Observed	S	classical	-0.0036464	0.0254227	188	0.886102
Observed	S	asset cluster	-0.0036464	0.0203732	7	0.863022
Observed	S	date cluster	-0.0036464	0.0140420	23	0.797420

Under the same date-cluster t_{23} reference, the smallest symmetric margin compatible with two one-sided 5% equivalence tests is 0.0008681, or 2.2805 times the magnitude of the pooled observed-Q benchmark. Retrospective margins equal to 10%, 25%, 50%, 100% and 200% of that descriptive benchmark all fail equivalence; the 300% margin passes. These are sensitivity calculations, not prespecified economic tolerances. If an external argument bounds the absolute differential-trend/spillover bias by Γ, an uncertainty interval for the causal contrast must additionally expand by Γ at each endpoint. The available panel does not identify that bias bound, so the fee result remains an association rather than an invariant causal effect.

4.3 Dynamic Monthly Event Study and Pretrend Sensitivity

The rebuilt analysis uses the original 192 sampled asset-days in 2022, eight assets and two dates per calendar month. Asset and sampled-date effects are combined with eleven BTC-

by-calendar-month interactions, using the June monthly mean as reference. The design has rank 42 and 150 residual degrees of freedom. January has event month -6, June -1, July zero and December five. These are calendar months, not separate twice-monthly sampling periods. Each coefficient independently matches the monthly treated-minus-control mean gap relative to June.

Table 7: Rebuilt monthly event effects for corrected observed-flow Q. June is omitted. Displayed uncertainty uses the declared date-cluster t_{23} approximation, with one treated asset and serial-dependence limitations.

Month	Event month	Effect	Date-cluster SE	Reference p
1	-6	0.0016829	0.0015641	0.2931
2	-5	0.0012269	0.0009032	0.1875
3	-4	0.0022112	0.0010371	0.0439
4	-3	0.0008700	0.0001785	6.358e-05
5	-2	0.0013016	0.0003074	0.0003145
7	0	0.0011669	0.0002622	0.0001829
8	1	0.0005572	0.0000298	2.028e-15
9	2	0.0021332	0.0000930	2.368e-17
10	3	-0.0000813	0.0003043	0.7916
11	4	0.0010152	0.0000057	1.52e-37
12	5	0.0018673	0.0004409	0.000313

The January–May joint pretrend reference is covariance-sensitive: classical $p = 0.323499$, HC3 $p = 0.288727$ and date-cluster $p = 0.0000392661$. The earlier literal $F = 0.42, p = 0.835$ is untraced and withdrawn. Month-cluster uncertainty degenerates because treated-month effects fit each month contrast; date-saturated interactions likewise degenerate under date clustering, and HC3 is unavailable at unit leverage. These failures do not imply zero uncertainty. No selected non-rejection validates parallel counterfactual trends. The complete legacy/observed, Q/S coefficient and six-covariance ledgers are retained in the event-study supplement.

The prior temporal- and cross-sectional-placebo literals have no verified generating chain in this revision. Their study questions remain open; the literals are withheld pending a reproducible design and appropriate exchangeability assumptions. Concurrent policies, spillovers, one treated asset and sampled-date outcome construction remain barriers to causal attribution.

4.4 Joint Cross-Venue Predictive Association

An unrestricted joint four-variable VAR uses price and flow from the recorder and Binance on 11 overlapping April 2021 dates, with ten-second bins, complete-bin restrictions and segment intercepts. Its baseline EMA spectral radii are 0.950614 (BTC), 0.949934 (ETH) and 0.948204 (ADA). At the BTC 60-second horizon, the normalized generalized Binance-to-recorder price share is 0.442926; the corresponding share across all 24 orthogonal orderings ranges approximately 0.17–0.8483. That interval concerns this asset, direction and horizon; it is not the range over all horizons. Raw-return and timestamp-shift sensitivities and all six horizons are retained. Quote-currency differences, subsecond alignment and shock identification prevent a causal transmission claim.

5 Liquidity States, Equity Representation and Financial Simulations

5.1 Spread-Interaction and Switching-Regression Diagnostics

The exploratory spread regression uses the first 50,000 supplied BTC records, an EMA deviation in dollars with adaptation 0.01 per retained record, the constructed signed base-unit feature, valid consecutive-second pairs, burn 500 and the lagged-spread 90th percentile. Its selected threshold is 5.874 dollars. The flow-slope contrast is 0.1242465 dollars per base unit, with 60-second HAC SE 0.2181307 and normal-reference $p = 0.568951$. These dimensional slopes are not the theoretical feedback Q; an assumed 10-basis-point conversion cannot create an empirical instability index.

Table 8: Exploratory BTC spread-interaction regression on the first 50,000 supplied records, with 49,497 valid transitions after burn and gap filtering. Flow is a constructed signed base-unit feature; the slope has dollars per base unit and is not the dimensionless Q.

Regime	Transitions	Flow slope	Mean inside notional	Residual SD
Spread at/below threshold	44,547	0.6267284	152,578.07	5.03849
Spread above threshold	4,950	0.7509749	29,216.24	7.30897

The wider-spread subset has lower recorded inside depth and residual SD ratio 1.450627.

Selection on observed spread is descriptive. The repaired switching regression uses exact joint transition posteriors, two specifications, four starts, two variance floors and all three assets under EMA/return measurements. On the seven expanding test dates April 13–19, all MSE-contrast intervals include zero, and every full-coefficient versus variance-only contrast interval includes zero. Some density scores improve relative to OLS. BTC full-switching SD ratios change from about 1,103 to 112 across the two variance floors, and four selected forecast fits reach their iteration limit. Neither this sensitivity nor non-rejection proves absent regimes.

5.2 Historical Flash-Crash Question and Constructed Scenarios

The 2010 equity flash crash and 2014 Treasury event motivate the question of liquidity depletion and feedback. The retained historical script does not ingest either event's transaction/account data: it assigns feedback coefficients and simulates one price/depth path; the Treasury function returns fixed inputs. Its protected path changes depth and external liquidation flow as well as clipping adaptive flow. The calculated scenario differences therefore cannot be attributed to gating alone, calibrated historical dealer losses, or measured policy protection. The original numerical outputs remain archived as constructed illustrations. Authenticating event-level data and an isolated counterfactual remains an open question.

Constructed 2010 scenario	Constructed 2014 scenario
Assigned depth and adaptive coefficients; simulated price paths	Assigned yield excursion and protected excursion
Protected path changes multiple inputs	Suppression follows from assigned endpoints
No historical TAQ ingest	No historical order/account ingest

Figure 4: Source audit of the retained historical illustrations. Neither scenario supplies a measured historical intervention effect. The original numerical studies and their questions are preserved in the evidence archive.

5.3 Supplied Equity Representation

The primary benchmark paper lists the source companies and raw euro-price encoding, but explains that its public representations are normalized to prevent reconstruction of original

Nasdaq data (Ntakaris et al., 2018). This does not authenticate the local company-label mapping or reconstructed physical scales.

The supplied CSV is now reproduced byte for byte from ten independently retrieved DecPre files by replaying its preserved notebook transformation. Its six-largest-jump/five-interval rule omits an endpoint, retaining 272,941 of 394,337 source events and dropping 121,396 (30.7848 percent). Legacy labels 2–5 also map to different inferred price blocks across days; they are not authenticated company identities.

We retain the legacy 49-session calculation as a representation audit and reconstruct full coverage using four largest finite price gaps plus an explicit endpoint. All 394,337 events and 50 eligible date/block sessions are retained; EMA 100, burn 500 and top-quote OFI use the declared per-column decimal conversion. The smallest selected gap is at least 12.3055 times the largest omitted gap in this sample, but this does not authenticate identities. The full price-block 1 mean is $Q = 0.0001936$, with exploratory ten-day reference $[-0.0000045, 0.0003918]$ spanning zero. Every block and interval is retained in the Internet Appendix evidence ledger. The mirror does not authenticate the Fairdata archive's full checksum or original currency/normalization denominators, and these diagnostics do not identify a crypto-versus-equity regulatory effect.

Table 9: Existing equity-source representation sensitivity. Legacy labels reproduce the supplied CSV; full price blocks use an explicit endpoint and four largest finite price gaps in each normalized source day. Company-label mapping, reconstructed physical currency/volume scales and primary-archive byte authentication remain open. Both constructions retain negative fits.

Construction	Rows	Sessions	Mean Q	Mean S	Maximum ρ
Legacy label 1	18,308	9	0.0000761	0.9793583	0.9880957
Legacy label 2	39,555	10	0.0002951	0.9766554	0.9837613
Legacy label 3	66,862	10	0.0004724	0.9768337	0.9860589
Legacy label 4	71,750	10	0.0004652	0.9756506	0.9809941
Legacy label 5	76,466	10	0.0005936	0.9727355	0.9890673
Full price block 1	29,744	10	0.0001936	0.9783431	0.9880957
Full price block 2	67,935	10	0.0004265	0.9782194	0.9860589
Full price block 3	62,898	10	0.0005447	0.9748446	0.9844946
Full price block 4	86,605	10	0.0002904	0.9772303	0.9820634
Full price block 5	147,155	10	0.0001433	0.9824020	0.9881783

5.4 Replayed Financial Scenarios and Accounting Limits

The existing funded-scenario grid has been rerun with its saved seed and inputs. Capacity means an inventory limit at fixed initial capital. Effective persistence differs from nominal metadata; the unconstrained transitions in this grid are supercritical. The recorded limit-hit event does not halt later trading. These rows cannot establish insolvency inside a stable system.

The separate lagged-memory dealer experiment has 48 cells with 400 paths each. Its implemented matrix is

$$J_{lag} = \begin{pmatrix} a & 1 \\ \eta Q & 1-\eta \end{pmatrix}.$$

Thus its eigenvalues must be calculated under that timing rather than the price-first theoretical matrix. Cash receives signed fills at the current mark plus half-spread, inventory takes the opposite fill, then equity is marked at the next price. Saved halt counts combine equity and position-limit events. They illustrate a model risk limit, not observed dealer defaults.

Here low-frequency power means long-run variance, not marginal variance. With two independent unit-variance shock streams, the lagged model's analytic flow LRV is $[(1-a)^2 + (Q\sigma/\lambda)^2]/(1-S)^2$; its saved marginal variance is a separate quantity. B3 can match the severe halt pattern with exogenous persistent flow, so these simulations do not isolate adaptive learning as its cause. Pricing, spread, leverage, fees, funding, fills and queue priority are hypothetical inputs. A tested cash identity is necessary but insufficient for market calibration.

Observed spread and displayed-depth calibration. The authenticated January source supplies a calibration of observable quote frictions. We select the last recorded snapshot in every observed UTC minute before quote validation, retain all 15,593 selected books, and do not interpolate missing minutes. The median quoted spread is 0.1000 quote units (0.04813 basis points); median ten-level bid and ask sizes are 19.692 and 19.171 in reported size units. Hypothetical sweeps consuming half of a side's displayed ten-level size have 90th-percentile costs above midpoint of 0.51409 for buys and 0.50576 for sells per reported size unit. A scalar level-by-level calculation is retained separately from the vectorized calculation. These quantities measure displayed-book frictions under assumed immediate access, rather than realized fills or guaranteed executable depth. Their static depth slopes

Table 10: Replayed existing funded scenarios: 1,000 paths per cell, fixed initial equity 10,000, capacity multiplier scales a 25-share limit. Halts are sticky inventory-limit hits, not a permanent trading ban or insolvency. The unconstrained system uses effective anchor 0.80 instead of nominal 0.40; all shown effective systems are supercritical.

S_{nom}	S_{eff}	ρ	Capacity	Shock	Hits	Defaults	Mean min equity
0.70	1.10	1.027	0.5	-0.2	691	0	9,998.95
0.70	1.10	1.027	0.5	-0.6	1000	0	9,999.95
0.70	1.10	1.027	1.0	-0.2	0	0	9,999.12
0.70	1.10	1.027	1.0	-0.6	0	0	9,998.66
0.70	1.10	1.027	2.0	-0.6	0	0	9,997.42
0.70	1.10	1.027	2.0	-2.0	0	0	9,983.77
0.82	1.22	1.074	0.5	-0.2	1000	0	9,999.56
0.82	1.22	1.074	0.5	-0.4	1000	0	9,999.56
0.82	1.22	1.074	1.0	-0.2	1000	0	9,995.35
0.82	1.22	1.074	1.0	-0.4	1000	0	9,996.44
0.82	1.22	1.074	1.0	-0.6	1000	0	9,998.41
0.82	1.22	1.074	1.0	-0.8	1000	0	9,999.91
0.82	1.22	1.074	2.0	-0.6	1000	0	9,978.23
0.82	1.22	1.074	2.0	-1.0	1000	0	9,979.79
0.82	1.22	1.074	2.0	-2.0	1000	0	9,985.62
1.18	1.58	1.226	0.5	-0.2	1000	0	9,998.80
1.18	1.58	1.226	0.5	-0.4	1000	0	9,998.80
1.18	1.58	1.226	1.0	-0.2	1000	0	9,994.98
1.18	1.58	1.226	1.0	-0.6	1000	0	9,994.98
1.18	1.58	1.226	1.0	-0.8	1000	0	9,994.98
1.18	1.58	1.226	2.0	-1.0	1000	0	9,979.76
1.18	1.58	1.226	2.0	-2.0	1000	0	9,979.76

Table 11: Reproduced existing lagged-memory dealer simulations at leverage parameter 10. A halt occurs at nonpositive equity or the model position limit; these causes are not separated in the archived counts. B1/B2/B3 reuse saved model flow moments, not estimated real dealer fills. All 48 cells and exact binomial intervals remain available.

S	Saved variance	Analytic LRV	Feedback	B1	B2	B3
0.50	1.0029	1.0000	44/400	45/400	42/400	43/400
0.60	1.0072	1.5664	118/400	46/400	45/400	126/400
0.70	1.0252	2.8056	249/400	52/400	56/400	276/400
0.80	1.0756	6.3906	373/400	59/400	89/400	391/400
0.90	1.2518	26.0000	400/400	106/400	188/400	400/400
0.95	1.6197	105.0625	400/400	211/400	350/400	400/400

are not the theorem's dynamic impact coefficient. Zero-spread scenario fills omit an observed friction. Account fees, funding, exposures and Gaussian measurement-error variance remain unavailable. Internet Appendix IA.C instead applies the venue's published January 2023 fee, margin and funding rules to the scenario inputs; this is a venue-rule, not an account, calibration. Both leverages lie inside venue limits, and a regular taker fee is 166 times the median half-spread. Consequently the revised financial interpretation is calibrated to observed quote frictions only; its dynamic and account primitives remain conditional.

A separate simulated five-input neural-policy study now has recovered saved weights. All 20 DQN/actor checkpoints independently reproduce 100 multiscale response records and their seed summaries. At the smallest radius, actor response R^2 ranges from 0.6540 to 0.9988, contradicting the saved claim that every neural policy lies below 0.70. The static fit/slope heuristic is not a proof of exponential-memory dynamics, and these checkpoints do not replace the distinct real-LOB policy or actual-execution records.

6 Observation Contracts and Reconstructed Robustness

6.1 Participant Information and Reset Requirements

Anonymous aggregate market features do not reveal participant identities. The exact merged rate equivalence theorem concerns a reset modeled price state with known anchor and impact; it does not imply that an arbitrary public VAR identifies its latent cohort measure. A hypothetical audited contract would provide participant-specific flow, state definitions and a verifiable reset. Such information can change identification, but regression consistency additionally needs excitation and valid innovations. These are proposed information requirements, not a statement that existing legal identifiers reveal every algorithm or internal learning state.

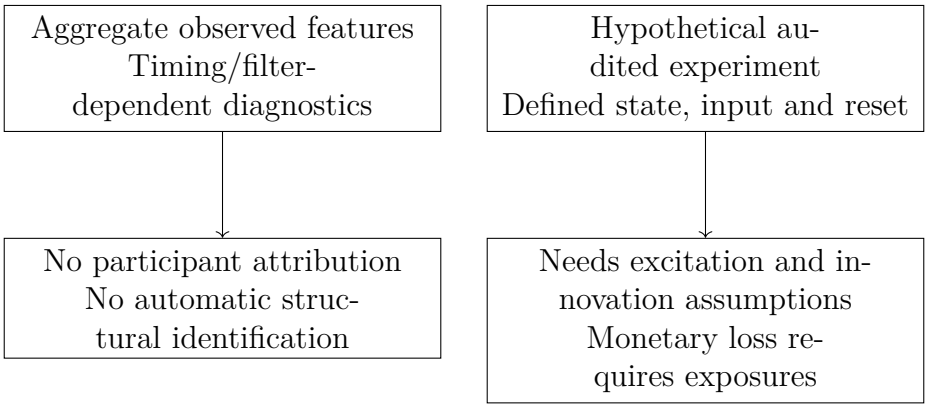


Figure 5: Information requirements for distinct experiments. Legal audit tags alone do not disclose a learning recursion or authenticate a cash-loss functional.

6.2 Reconstructed Date-Shuffle, Lead-Flow and Sign Diagnostics

The previously untraced placebo questions have now been computed under a written retrospective protocol on the existing recorder sample. Date relabelling uses each date's longest continuous segment, position alignment and truncation; all relabellings exclude fixed points. The six-tap price-to-flow regression has a date-mean covariance and is projected onto the negative orthant. That orthant contains the negative Hausdorff-memory cone, so its rejection

is a sufficient observable sign restriction diagnostic under the assumed Gaussian covariance law. The diagnostic does not establish that regression taps equal latent algorithm kernels. It does not certify the full continuous-cone test or repair endogenous regressors.

Table 12: Reconstructed recorder diagnostics: 199 fixed-point-free whole-date flow relabellings and 1,999 Gaussian vertex draws for the six-tap negative orthant. The printed ranks are simulation diagnostics at finite resolution, not randomized-treatment or finite-sample market p values.

Asset	Date-shuffle rank	Forward-paired Q	Negative-orthant rank
BTC	0.0050	0.0125227	0.0005
ETH	0.0050	0.0113018	0.0005
ADA	0.0050	0.0072058	0.0005

All three shuffle ranks reach the 1/200 simulation floor, and all three Gaussian orthant ranks reach the 1/2000 floor. These are lower-resolution ranks rather than exact zero probabilities. Cross-date exchangeability and the Gaussian covariance reference remain unproved in 13 dates. Lead-flow pairing reproduces the much larger forward diagnostic; it is evidence that timing matters, not a valid exclusion of reverse causation. The independent ledger retains all coefficients, covariances and relabelling indices.

6.3 Original-Panel Lag Controls and Horizon Units

The original 768-unit lag grid is newly recomputed from the authenticated current archives. It uses observed flow and complete ten-second bars, without filling or cross-gap regressors. The digital ledger retains every coefficient and denominator as well as date means and intervals. A positive adjusted mean cannot distinguish meta-order execution from adaptive feedback, and finite lag controls do not prove a positive asymptotic floor.

6.4 Sampling and Filter Sensitivity

The complete recorder grid reports each computed construction. The mechanical EMA anchor is $1 - 2/(W/\Delta + 1)$ and is distinct from a fitted VAR coefficient. Finite grid compar-

Table 13: Fresh controls on all 768 original study units, using observed flow. L counts ten-second bars: the displayed horizons are 10, 50, 150, 300, 600 and 900 seconds. $L = 1$ equals baseline VAR. Date intervals and every segment denominator are retained in the digital ledger.

Pair	$L = 1$	$L = 5$	$L = 15$	$L = 30$	$L = 60$	$L = 90$
BTC/USDT	0.0006350	0.0006233	0.0005719	0.0005751	0.0006352	0.0006545
ETH/USDT	0.0005657	0.0003970	0.0003256	0.0003358	0.0003685	0.0003876
SOL/USDT	0.0002036	0.0001401	0.0001265	0.0001314	0.0001270	0.0001371
ADA/USDT	0.0003953	0.0003466	0.0003536	0.0003623	0.0003734	0.0004001
DOGE/USDT	0.0002511	0.0001911	0.0001588	0.0001622	0.0001604	0.0002019
BNB/USDT	0.0004587	0.0003060	0.0002888	0.0002731	0.0003099	0.0003253
XRP/USDT	0.0002292	0.0002245	0.0001978	0.0001741	0.0002046	0.0002194
LTC/USDT	0.0003068	0.0002120	0.0002666	0.0002650	0.0002881	0.0003046

isons do not establish a universal $O(1/W)$ economic law or robustness to every discretization. Some coarse-clock Q intervals include zero.

6.5 January Depth and Retrospective Forecasts

The January sample has 3,730,870 raw snapshots spanning January 9–20, 2023. Top-quote OFI and the 120-second EMA yield 844,621 valid transitions in 152 segments over 12 dates. The mean is $Q = 0.000910232$. The controlled diagnostic is $Q_{30} = -0.001296032$, with date interval $[-0.001567464, -0.001024600]$. The CSV exactly matches both the original siavashraz version 1 CSV (uploader-declared MIT) and a reconstruction of the separately distributed szh765 Parquet (uploader-declared Apache 2.0). The original uploader describes Binance Bitcoin perpetual BTCUSDT.P data at nominal 250-millisecond sampling; this is provider documentation rather than independent exchange authentication. The sample was previously examined; it is not an untouched prospective holdout. A fresh retrospective AR/VAR comparison now reconstructs this same sample, matching all 152 prior eligible segments and 844,621 baseline transitions. Training-only normalization and fitting precede six expanding evaluation dates, January 15–20, 2023. At lags one, two, three and six seconds, mean price-MSE reductions are 1.84275, 1.78394, 1.77683 and 1.75939 percent relative to AR. All four date-Student reference intervals are positive. With only six consecutive eval-

Table 14: Complete computed recorder grid: existing BTC/ETH/ADA sample, observed flow, gap-aware filters. Each cell uses 13 dates. Intervals use a retrospective date Student reference; 60-second windows at 60-second sampling are excluded because the filter is degenerate.

Asset	Δ (s)	W (s)	Q	Date interval	S	Date interval
BTC	1	60	0.0006658	[0.0004847, 0.0008469]	0.9771337	[0.9762386, 0.9780288]
BTC	1	300	0.0003072	[0.0002163, 0.0003982]	0.9952180	[0.9949597, 0.9954762]
BTC	1	900	0.0001660	[0.0001031, 0.0002288]	0.9981992	[0.9981008, 0.9982977]
BTC	10	60	0.0021823	[0.0002850, 0.0040796]	0.7497710	[0.7362451, 0.7632969]
BTC	10	300	0.0019353	[0.0003179, 0.0035527]	0.9425983	[0.9388340, 0.9463626]
BTC	10	900	0.0011979	[0.0002926, 0.0021032]	0.9785557	[0.9768400, 0.9802714]
BTC	60	300	0.0017936	[-0.0028178, 0.0064051]	0.6494995	[0.6307149, 0.6682842]
BTC	60	900	0.0017777	[-0.0024546, 0.0060101]	0.8562867	[0.8458932, 0.8666802]
ETH	1	60	0.0004845	[0.0002733, 0.0006958]	0.9728547	[0.9714421, 0.9742673]
ETH	1	300	0.0002829	[0.0001828, 0.0003830]	0.9941826	[0.9937325, 0.9946327]
ETH	1	900	0.0001629	[0.0000982, 0.0002275]	0.9978294	[0.9976065, 0.9980522]
ETH	10	60	0.0011250	[-0.0001413, 0.0023913]	0.7299855	[0.7150779, 0.7448931]
ETH	10	300	0.0009795	[0.0000628, 0.0018963]	0.9391562	[0.9338698, 0.9444427]
ETH	10	900	0.0007203	[0.0000851, 0.0013554]	0.9781093	[0.9759674, 0.9802512]
ETH	60	300	-0.0027069	[-0.0078037, 0.0023900]	0.6705125	[0.6512727, 0.6897523]
ETH	60	900	-0.0009565	[-0.0048536, 0.0029407]	0.8679761	[0.8593363, 0.8766159]
ADA	1	60	0.0002474	[0.0001359, 0.0003589]	0.9705855	[0.9686803, 0.9724907]
ADA	1	300	0.0001361	[0.0000809, 0.0001913]	0.9935311	[0.9930170, 0.9940453]
ADA	1	900	0.0000793	[0.0000438, 0.0001148]	0.9974690	[0.9971371, 0.9978008]
ADA	10	60	0.0007698	[0.0001114, 0.0014281]	0.7232232	[0.7138175, 0.7326289]
ADA	10	300	0.0006163	[0.0001565, 0.0010762]	0.9350377	[0.9304137, 0.9396617]
ADA	10	900	0.0003875	[0.0000696, 0.0007053]	0.9763042	[0.9741121, 0.9784963]
ADA	60	300	0.0016322	[-0.0006946, 0.0039589]	0.6486999	[0.6276182, 0.6697817]
ADA	60	900	0.0014004	[-0.0007271, 0.0035280]	0.8586178	[0.8480483, 0.8691874]

uation dates, retrospective choices and serial dependence, these are predictive associations rather than guaranteed confidence coverage or causal learning identification. Every lag and both price/flow loss targets are retained. Non-rejection neither proves equal prediction nor validates a learning mechanism.

7 Regulatory Policy Implications and Conclusion

7.1 Pre-Trade Controls and the Scope of the Proposed Bound

Existing market-access rules already include pre-trade controls. SEC Rule 15c3-5 requires controls against orders exceeding appropriate credit/capital thresholds and erroneous orders; the SEC staff FAQ discusses their application to quotes and automated activity (SEC, 2010; SEC Staff, 2017). The present mathematical bound is a conditional design input. Its derivation does not establish regulatory compliance, improved welfare or an implemented exchange safety mechanism.

7.2 An Explicit Finite-Window Quantity Gate

An initial-state norm radius alone does not specify an executed-volume limit. Let v_j be signed executed quantity, H its input map and Cz a financially specified monetary loss output:

$$z_{j+1} = Jz_j + Hv_j, \qquad \ell_t = Cz_t, \qquad \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} |v_j| \le V.$$

Set $b_t = CJ^t z_0$ and $g_t = \max_{0\le k<t} |CJ^k H|$. Under an absolute-output budget, the sharp finite-window envelope is $|b_t| + L_{\text{other}} + (g_t + c_{\text{exec}})V$, where L_{other} is a declared monetary reserve and c_{exec} bounds monetary cost per executed quantity. Provided all background outputs, including $t = 0$, are within budget, the cap is

$$\bar{R} = \frac{V^*}{\tau}, \qquad V^* = \min_{\substack{1\le t\le N \\ g_t + c_{\text{exec}} > 0}} \frac{B - L_{\text{other}} - |b_t|}{g_t + c_{\text{exec}}}, \tag{45}$$

for a window lasting τ seconds. This is quantity per second, not order-message count. Zero-gain times impose no quantity restriction if their background is feasible; an already exceeded background cannot be certified by setting a cap to zero. No Schur condition is needed for this finite-horizon calculation.

Proof. Superposition yields $\ell_t = b_t + \sum_{j<t} CJ^{t-1-j} Hv_j$. The maximum coefficient bounds the input term by $g_t V$; an adversarial single pulse at its maximizing lag attains the bound under the declared quantity ball. Costs add at most $c_{\text{exec}} V$. Taking the minimum over

every time gives the largest permitted cap for this linear criterion. The signed one-sided loss variant replaces $|b_t|$ with b_t. □

The Markov coefficients and this cap are unchanged by consistent invertible changes of state coordinates. The old map $\|z_0\| \leq |x_0|$ is unsupported for a state with unobserved cohort components; the price component alone is a lower, not upper, bound on its Euclidean norm. Displayed top-five quantity and price impact do not determine H, and leveraged notional is not loss-absorbing capital.

Cohort nonidentification does not by itself make every financial functional unknown. For two reset models with identical price input responses and the same calibrated monetary price exposure, equality of Markov coefficients gives identical finite-window caps even when cohort counts differ. This is an input/output functional, not a first-use control result. Unreset hidden states, unknown exposure/input maps, nonlinear marks and changing positions require additional information.

In the one-asset positive-cohort model with $S = a + \kappa \sum_i q_i < 1$, a reset price-only monetary output has executed-input peak $|\lambda|\kappa$, while its sustained-input gain is $|\lambda|\kappa/(1-S)$. Nonnegative row sums and the DC response prove this distinction. It requires the stated fixed output, input and model conditions; it does not include fundamental risk or accumulated costs. The all-state initial-shock norm and the physical execution-input risk can rank impact changes differently. The supplement gives an exact example in which the state norm falls while execution gain rises. These disturbance/output contracts must therefore be specified before interpreting a non-normality metric financially.

Each refreshed window must carry the actual state and updated capital, cost and uncertainty bounds. With $z_{t+1} = 0.9z_t + v_t$ and budget one, two unit pulses in consecutive one-step windows produce output 1.9; carrying the first state reduces the second permitted pulse to 0.1. Thus window resets do not establish perpetual solvency. The detailed proof, coordinate/unit checks and exact failure examples are in the input-gate supplement. Operational use still requires authenticated positions, marks, executions, fees/funding/margin rules and model/noise/input coverage. The empirical maintained-model rejections are not cured by this conditional formula.

7.3 Market Design: Continuous Auctions vs. Frequent Batch Auctions

Our findings also speak directly to the structural debate on market design initiated by Budish, Cramton, and Shim (2015), who propose replacing continuous double auctions with Frequent Batch Auctions (FBAs) to eliminate latency arbitrage. Batch matching changes execution timing and incentives; a feedback model can also be posed across successive batches. This paper does not estimate its comparative economic effect. The finite-window quantity bound can be examined under either matching design when its input/output and accounting assumptions hold. Comparative welfare, execution feasibility and effectiveness across continuous and batch auctions remain unvalidated.

7.4 Information Missing from Public Market Feeds

Each result uses a declared information contract. Exact reset response functions determine a merged representation rather than participant identities. Noisy-price testing costs require the stated innovation law and exclusion of richer financial records. Exact marked equity and natural excitation supply constructive counterexamples to a universal capital barrier. The positive-class quantity certificate requires authenticated impact, margin and account assumptions; it does not require individual learning-rate identities once that model class is verified. Covariance rejection and measurement sensitivity prevent substituting public reduced-form coefficients for these operational conditions.

7.5 Conclusion

We establish a resource distinction within a precisely defined memory-resolution experiment: lifetime executed quantity of order δ^{-2} is necessary and sufficient for a known symmetric pair, while average power gives horizon order δ^{-4}. Actual probe-trader execution cost gives matching capital order δ^{-4} for funded deterministic probes under the restricted noisy-price contract. A separate counterparty cash/margin contract gives a sharp quantity allowance, including the inventory created by the probe. Exact equity disclosure and natural excitation supply constructive counterexamples to a universal capital barrier. A fixed price-exposure output is a separate contract. More waiting alone cannot overcome a fixed lifetime quantity

allowance; the result does not bound every tailored safe strategy. The empirical reconstruction shows strong timing/filter sensitivity and maintained-model rejection, rather than participant-level learning attribution. Existing simulations distinguish capacity events, defaults and effective dynamics. Real-market financial calibration and independent specialist assessment remain necessary before publication and operational claims.

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Internet Appendix

From Human Markets to Machine Markets

IA.A Complete Proof of Theorem 2.14

Throughout, $\|\cdot\|$ is the Euclidean vector norm and the induced operator (spectral) norm, and $z_t = J^t z_0$ with $\rho(J) < 1$.

Preliminary: the gains are finite. By Gelfand's formula, $\|J^t\|^{1/t} \to \rho(J) < 1$, so $\|J^t\| \to 0$ and $M_I \equiv \sup_{t\geq 0} \|J^t\| < \infty$. Hence $M_C = \sup_{t\geq 0} \|CJ^t\| \leq \|C\| M_I < \infty$. Taking $t = 0$ gives $M_C \geq \|C\|$ and $M_I \geq \|I\| = 1$.

Part 1 (exact safe radius). If $C = 0$, every z_0 satisfies $\sup_t \|CJ^t z_0\| = 0 \leq B$, so the criterion imposes no bound. Suppose $C \neq 0$, so $M_C \geq \|C\| > 0$. *Sufficiency.* If $\|z_0\| \leq B/M_C$, then for every t,

$$\|CJ^t z_0\| \leq \|CJ^t\| \, \|z_0\| \leq M_C \cdot B/M_C = B. \tag{IA.1}$$

Necessity. Let $r > B/M_C$. Then $B/r < M_C$, so by the definition of the supremum there is t^* with $\|CJ^{t^*}\| > B/r$. The spectral norm of a finite matrix is attained: there is a unit vector v with $\|CJ^{t^*}v\| = \|CJ^{t^*}\|$. The initial state $z_0 = rv$ has $\|z_0\| = r$ and $\|CJ^{t^*}z_0\| = r\|CJ^{t^*}\| > B$, violating the criterion. Hence the set of radii r for which every $\|z_0\| \leq r$ satisfies the criterion is exactly $[0, B/M_C]$, and its maximum is $r^*_{\text{exact}} = B/M_C$.

Part 2 (Kreiss bounds), with $C = I$. *Lower bound.* Fix $z \in \mathbb{C}$ with $|z| > 1$. The partial sums $S_T = \sum_{t=0}^{T} z^{-(t+1)} J^t$ converge absolutely, because $\sum_t |z|^{-(t+1)} \|J^t\| \leq M_I \sum_t |z|^{-(t+1)} = M_I/(|z| - 1) < \infty$. Telescoping gives $(zI - J)S_T = I - z^{-(T+1)} J^{T+1} \to I$, so $zI - J$ is invertible and $(zI - J)^{-1} = \sum_{t\geq 0} z^{-(t+1)} J^t$. Therefore

$$(|z| - 1) \, \|(zI - J)^{-1}\| \leq (|z| - 1) \cdot \frac{M_I}{|z| - 1} = M_I. \tag{IA.2}$$

Taking the supremum over $|z| > 1$ yields $\mathcal{K}(J) \le M_I$.

Upper bound. For any $n \times n$ complex matrix, Spijker (1991) proved $\sup_{t \ge 0} \|J^t\| \le e\, n\, \mathcal{K}(J)$ in the spectral norm, with $\mathcal{K}$ defined exactly as in (34); this resolved the LeVeque–Trefethen conjecture. Real matrices are a special case. We use this published theorem without reproving it.

Radius bounds. Combining, $\mathcal{K}(J) \le M_I \le e\, n\, \mathcal{K}(J)$. Since $M_I \ge 1$, $\mathcal{K}(J) \ge M_I/(e\, n) > 0$, so all three quantities are positive and finite. Dividing B through the chain and using Part 1 with $C = I$ ($r^*_{\text{exact}} = B/M_I$) gives (35).

Part 3 (fixed spectrum, vanishing radius). Fix $\rho \in (0, 1)$ and $B > 0$. For $\theta > 0$ let $J_\theta = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} \rho & \theta \\ 0 & \rho \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ and $C = (1, 0)$. The characteristic polynomial is $(\lambda - \rho)^2$, so $\rho(J_\theta) = \rho$ for every θ. The matrix is non-normal: $J_\theta J_\theta^\top - J_\theta^\top J_\theta = \mathrm{diag}(\theta^2, -\theta^2) \ne 0$. Its powers are $J_\theta^t = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} \rho^t & t\theta\rho^{t-1} \\ 0 & \rho^t \end{smallmatrix}\right) \to 0$, so $M_C(J_\theta) < \infty$ and Part 1 applies. Since $CJ_\theta = (\rho, \theta)$,

$$M_C(J_\theta) \ge \|CJ_\theta\| = \sqrt{\rho^2 + \theta^2} \ge \theta, \qquad \text{so} \qquad r^*_{\text{exact}}(J_\theta) = \frac{B}{M_C(J_\theta)} \le \frac{B}{\theta} \xrightarrow[\theta \to \infty]{} 0. \tag{IA.3}$$

This holds for every fixed $B > 0$ while the spectral radius stays at ρ. □

IA.B Pseudospectral Contours and Non-Normal Resolvent Bounds

To gain deeper visual and geometric intuition into why the spectral radius fails to predict dealer solvency, we examine the ϵ-pseudospectrum of the closed-loop market Jacobian. For any $\epsilon > 0$, the ϵ-pseudospectrum $\sigma_\epsilon(J)$ of matrix J is defined as the set of complex numbers $z \in \mathbb{C}$ satisfying:

$$\sigma_\epsilon(J) \equiv \left\{ z \in \mathbb{C} : \|(zI - J)^{-1}\|_2 \ge \epsilon^{-1} \right\}. \tag{IA.4}$$

Equivalently, $\sigma_\epsilon(J)$ represents the union of all eigenvalues of perturbed matrices $J + E$ across all perturbations with $\|E\|_2 \le \epsilon$.

As visualized in Figure 6, in a normal system, the pseudospectrum consists of concentric disks of radius ϵ centered at the eigenvalues: $\sigma_\epsilon(J) = \bigcup_i \{z : |z - \lambda_i| \le \epsilon\}$. However, for a constructed non-normal matrix, computed pseudospectral contours can stretch along the

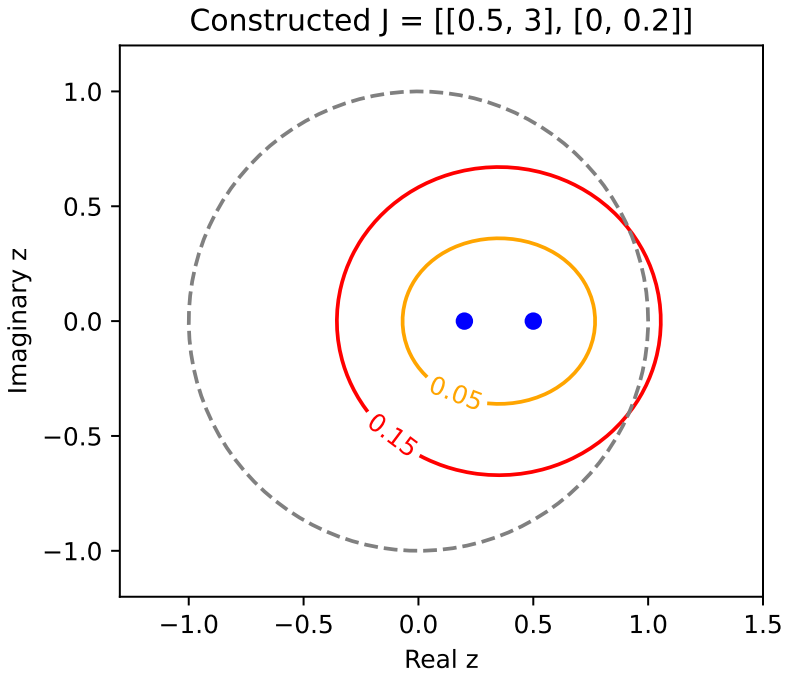


Figure 6: Computed singular-value contours for the declared constructed matrix $J = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 0.5 & 3 \\ 0 & 0.2 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ at 0.05 and 0.15. Its spectral radius is 0.5; the 0.15 contour crosses the unit circle. This fixed-coordinate illustration is not a calibrated cohort-market or monetary-loss experiment.

off-diagonal coupling direction, protruding significantly outside the unit circle $\{|z| = 1\}$ even when the spectral radius $\rho(J) = 0.50$ is well within the interior.

The Kreiss constant $\mathcal{K}(J)$ measures the maximum ratio by which these pseudospectral contours protrude beyond the unit circle:

$$\mathcal{K}(J) = \sup_{\epsilon>0} \frac{\alpha_\epsilon(J) - 1}{\epsilon}, \qquad \alpha_\epsilon(J) \equiv \sup_{z\in\sigma_\epsilon(J)} |z|. \tag{IA.5}$$

Whenever $\mathcal{K}(J) \gg 1$, small high-frequency liquidity shocks are magnified by the non-normal resolvent, inducing large transient balance-sheet losses that exhaust dealer margin buffers before eigenvalue decay can assert itself.

IA.C Venue-Rule Calibration of the Scenario Inputs

Scope. This section is a *venue-rule calibration, not an account calibration.* It applies rules that Binance published for USDⓈ-margined (USDⓈ-M) perpetual futures in January 2023 to the paper's hypothetical scenario equity $E_0 = 10{,}000$ USDT and leverage parameters $L \in \{10, 20\}$, reading model monetary units as USDT. No account, position, fill, margin-call or realized funding-payment record is used, and none is available to us. Liquidation prices follow the venue's published isolated-margin, one-way formula and ignore fees, funding accrual, the mark-to-last price basis, and insurance-fund or auto-deleveraging mechanics.

Sources. (i) The USDⓈ-M fee schedule archived by the Internet Archive on December 9, 2022 and January 22, 2023; the two snapshots bracket the January 9–20 sample and are identical. (ii) The public BTCUSDT leverage and maintenance-margin brackets archived on January 9, 17 and 23, 2023. The January 9 and 17 snapshots are identical (last update November 17, 2022). A venue update at 11:47 UTC on January 20 raised the maximum leverage of tiers 3–4 but left every maintenance rate and maintenance amount unchanged. (iii) The official monthly BTCUSDT funding file for January 2023 from `data.binance.vision`, whose SHA-256 matches the published checksum. Archive URLs, file hashes, the script and its receipt are in the replication package (`venue_rule_calibration_20261010`). The midpoint and book frictions come from the displayed-book calibration in Section 5.4.

Fees and funding. A regular (VIP 0) account paid 2.0 basis points as maker and 4.0 as taker on USDT-margined contracts (1.8 and 3.6 with the BNB discount). The highest tier, VIP 9, paid 0 and 1.7. At the median midpoint of 20,783.25 USDT, the regular one-way taker fee is 8.31 USDT per BTC. That is 166 times the median half-spread of 0.05 USDT and 16 times the 90th-percentile half-side sweep cost of 0.514 USDT. The 36 eight-hour funding settlements from January 9 to 20 average 0.949 basis points (range -0.067 to 4.585; 34 positive). They sum to 0.342% of notional, a simple annualized mean of 10.4%. For a regular taker, fees and funding, not the displayed spread, therefore dominate trading frictions. The zero-spread scenario fills omit a friction that is small relative to these venue charges.

Table 15: Published January 2023 Binance rules applied to the hypothetical scenario equity $E_0 = 10{,}000$ USDT at the median midpoint. Venue-rule calibration, not account calibration.

	$L = 10$	$L = 20$
Notional (USDT)	100,000	200,000
Margin tier (notional range, USDT)	2 (50k–250k)	2 (50k–250k)
Venue maximum leverage in tier	100	100
Minimum initial margin rate μ	1.0%	1.0%
Buffer $A_0 = E_0 - \mu\|I_0\|p_0$ (USDT)	9,000	8,000
Maintenance rate / maintenance amount	0.5% / 50	0.5% / 50
Maintenance margin at entry (USDT)	450	950
Loss to maintenance breach at entry (USDT)	9,550	9,050
Adverse move to liquidation: long / short	9.60% / 9.50%	4.55% / 4.50%
Regular taker round-trip fee (USDT)	80	160
Funding paid by a long, Jan 9–20 (USDT)	341.63	683.27

Margin. Table 15 reports the results. Both scenario leverages lie inside the venue's limit: each notional falls in tier 2, which allowed up to 100×. With 10,000 USDT of equity the venue allowed at most 250,000 USDT of notional before the January 20 update and 500,000 afterwards, so $L = 10$ and $L = 20$ are well inside the feasible set. In the notation of (31), the venue's minimum initial margin rate is $\mu = 1\%$. The archived simulations halt at nonpositive equity. The venue instead liquidates when equity reaches maintenance margin, so a venue-consistent loss budget is at most 9,550 USDT for $L = 10$ and 9,050 for $L = 20$. Because the exact safe radius in Part 1 of Theorem 2.14 is linear in B, these budgets shrink r^*_{exact} by 4.5% and 9.5% relative to $B = E_0$, for any J and C.

What remains uncalibrated. The rules above do not identify any trader's actual fee tier, rebates, position, margin mode, realized funding, fills, queue priority or liquidation outcome. Those quantities require account records, so the dynamic and account primitives of the scenarios remain conditional.